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Lesson 01: Introduction to Social Psychology

Definition of Social Psychology

Social Psychology is the scientific study of how people's thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are influenced by others.

According to **Gordon Allport (1985)**, social psychology studies how thoughts, feelings, and behavior are influenced by the actual, imagined, or implied presence of others.

According to **Brehm, Kassin, and Fein (2002)**, it is the scientific study of how individuals think, feel, and behave toward other people.

Nature of Social Psychology

Social Psychology is a scientific discipline.

It studies social influences on human behavior.

It overlaps with personality psychology, cognitive psychology, sociology, anthropology, and communication.

It uses scientific methods to understand human social behavior.

Main Elements of Social Psychology

Thoughts refer to what people think about themselves and others.

Feelings refer to emotions and attitudes.

Behaviors refer to actions and responses toward others.

The influence of other people is the central focus of social psychology.

Main Questions of Interest in Social Psychology

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Thinking about the self and others.

Evaluating people and relationships.

Interacting with others.

Thinking About the Self and Others

Social Cognition

Studies how people process and understand social information.

Example: How do juries decide guilt or innocence?

Person Perception

Studies how people form impressions of others.

Example: How do we know when someone is lying?

Attribution

Refers to the process of explaining the causes of behavior.

The Self

Studies how people think and feel about themselves.

Example: Body image and self-concept.

Evaluating People and Relationships

Attitude

A positive or negative evaluation of people, objects, or ideas.

Attitude Change

Studies how and why attitudes change over time.

Prejudice

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Negative judgments, stereotypes, and discrimination toward groups.

Interpersonal Attraction

Studies why people like, love, or become friends with others.

Close Relationships

Examines how relationships develop, maintain, and end.

Interacting with Others

Social Influence

Studies how one person's behavior affects another person's behavior.

Helping Behavior

Examines why people help others.

Aggression

Studies behaviors intended to harm others.

Interpersonal Power

Studies how individuals influence and control others.

Groups

Examines behavior of people within groups.

Presence of Others and Its Effects

Actual Presence

People physically present can influence behavior.

Example: Audience affecting a player's performance.

Imagined Presence

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Thinking about others can affect behavior even when they are absent.

Example: Parents' influence on a child's decisions.

Implied Presence

Signs, symbols, and social expectations influence behavior.

Example: "You are being watched" notices.

Factors Affecting Social Behavior

Human behavior is influenced by evolutionary factors.

Human behavior is influenced by cultural factors.

Human behavior is influenced by individual factors.

Human behavior is influenced by situational factors.

Human behavior is influenced by mediating variables.

Broad Group-Level Explanations

Evolutionary Factors

Behavior may be influenced by inherited tendencies developed through evolution.

Cultural Factors

Values, beliefs, and traditions of a society shape behavior.

Different cultures show different levels of aggression and social behavior.

Individual-Level Explanations

Heredity and Physiology

Genes and hormones influence behavior.

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Testosterone is linked with aggression.

Past Experiences

Childhood learning and family upbringing affect behavior.

Current Situational Factors

Immediate surroundings and circumstances influence actions.

Example: Group pressure and media violence.

Mediating Variables

Beliefs

Knowledge and information held by a person.

Attitudes

Positive or negative evaluations.

Schemas

Mental frameworks used to organize information.

Emotions

Temporary feelings that guide behavior.

Personality Traits

Stable characteristics influencing behavior.

Current Responses of the Individual

A person's thoughts, feelings, and behavior are the result of interactions among evolutionary, cultural, individual, situational, and mediating factors.

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Important Exam Points

Definition of Social Psychology by Gordon Allport (1985) is very important.

Social Psychology is the scientific study of how others influence our thoughts, feelings, and behaviors.

The three main elements of social psychology are thoughts, feelings, and behaviors.

The three main questions of social psychology are thinking about self and others, evaluating people and relationships, and interacting with others.

The topics under thinking about self and others are social cognition, person perception, attribution, and the self.

The topics under evaluating people and relationships are attitude, attitude change, prejudice, interpersonal attraction, and close relationships.

The topics under interacting with others are social influence, helping behavior, aggression, interpersonal power, and groups.

The three types of presence affecting behavior are actual presence, imagined presence, and implied presence.

The three explanations of social behavior are broad group-level explanations, individual-level explanations, and mediating variables.

The main mediating variables are beliefs, attitudes, schemas, emotions, and personality traits.

Remember: Social Psychology = Scientific Study of How Other People Influence Human Thoughts, Feelings, and Behaviors. ✓

5 Important MCQs – Introduction to Social Psychology

1. Social psychology is best defined as the scientific study of:

Intelligence and memory

Personality traits only

How thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are influenced by others ✓

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Biological processes of the brain

Correct Answer: How thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are influenced by others

2. According to Gordon Allport, social psychology examines the influence of the actual, imagined, or _____ presence of others.

Direct

Implied ✓

Physical

Emotional

Correct Answer: Implied

3. Which topic of social psychology deals with explaining the causes of another person's behavior?

Attitude Change

Social Influence

Attribution ✓

Interpersonal Attraction

Correct Answer: Attribution

4. Which of the following is an example of the imagined presence of others affecting behavior?

A speed limit sign on a motorway

Fans cheering during a cricket match

Thinking about parents' disapproval before smoking ✓

A security camera in a store

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Correct Answer: Thinking about parents' disapproval before smoking

5. Which of the following is considered a mediating variable in social psychology?

Culture

Evolution

Personality Traits ✓

Geography

Correct Answer: Personality Traits

Lesson 02: Introduction to Social Psychology

Is Social Psychology Simply Common Sense?

Many people believe that social psychology is only common sense because it studies familiar human behavior.

This belief is called the **"I knew it all along" phenomenon** or **hindsight bias**.

People often think social psychology only restates what they already know.

Scientific research has shown that many common beliefs are actually incorrect.

Events often seem obvious after we know the outcome but are difficult to predict beforehand.

Social psychology uses scientific methods rather than personal opinions and assumptions.

Common Sense vs Scientific Findings

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Many beliefs that appear true have been disproved through research.

People are not always best at detecting lies by looking at faces.

People paid a large amount of money for a boring task may not enjoy it more.

Playing violent games does not necessarily reduce aggression.

Victims are not always helped more when many bystanders are present.

Scientific findings sometimes challenge common beliefs and assumptions.

Social Psychology and Sociology

Social Psychology focuses on the influence of people on the individual.

Sociology focuses on groups, societies, social roles, culture, and social structures.

Social psychologists study individual thoughts, feelings, and behaviors.

Sociologists study social systems, institutions, poverty, crime, and social norms.

Social psychology mainly uses experiments.

Sociology mainly uses observation and correlational methods.

Both disciplines influence each other and contribute to understanding social behavior.

Social Psychology and Personality Psychology

Both disciplines focus on individuals.

Personality psychology studies individual differences.

Social psychology studies how people influence one another.

Personality psychologists ask why some people are more aggressive than others.

Social psychologists ask how situations can make most people behave aggressively or kindly.

Social psychology focuses on common human behavior.

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Personality psychology focuses on unique personal characteristics.

Social Psychology and Biology

Human behavior is influenced by both nature and nurture.

Biological factors and life experiences work together to shape behavior.

Inherited characteristics influence behavior.

Learning and environmental experiences also influence behavior.

Social neuroscientists study the relationship between biological processes and social behavior.

Complex behaviors cannot be explained only by biology.

Both biological and social factors must be considered.

Social Psychology as a Profession

Most PhD-level social psychologists work in colleges and universities.

Some social psychologists work in business organizations and government departments.

Many social psychologists work in clinics, health agencies, and human service organizations.

In Pakistan, social psychologists mainly work in universities and NGOs.

The field offers diverse career opportunities.

Applying Social Psychology

Social psychology helps solve real-life social problems.

It studies issues such as aggression, prejudice, health, education, law, and disasters.

Research changes according to social needs and events.

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World War II encouraged research on prejudice and conformity.

The Civil Rights Movement encouraged research on stereotypes and discrimination.

Increasing violence led to research on aggression.

Health problems led to research on social influences on health.

The 9/11 attacks increased research on terrorism.

The 2005 Pakistan earthquake encouraged research on disasters and PTSD.

History of Social Psychology

Social psychology is a relatively young discipline.

Most of its growth occurred after the 1950s.

Its history has strong American roots.

The Early Years (1884–1934)

Norman Triplett conducted the first social psychology experiment in 1897.

He studied how the presence of others affects performance.

His research introduced the experimental method to social psychology.

William McDougall and Edward Ross published the first books on social psychology.

Floyd Allport established social psychology as a scientific discipline.

He emphasized that social psychology is the study of individuals.

He conducted research on conformity, social facilitation, and nonverbal communication.

The Coming of Age (1935–1945)

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Two major events influenced social psychology.

The Great Depression in the USA.

Political and social upheaval in Europe.

The Society for the Psychological Study of Social Issues (SPSSI) was established in 1936.

Many European psychologists migrated to America.

Kurt Lewin became one of the most influential social psychologists.

He emphasized the importance of both research and action.

His famous statement was:

"No research without action and no action without research."

Rapid Expansion (1946–1969)

Social psychology expanded rapidly after World War II.

Theodore Adorno studied the authoritarian personality.

Stanley Milgram conducted obedience experiments.

Solomon Asch studied conformity.

Research on persuasion, aggression, helping behavior, and attraction increased.

Leon Festinger developed the Theory of Cognitive Dissonance in 1957.

This theory states that people try to maintain consistency between their thoughts and actions.

Research during the 1960s focused on social problems and social change.

Crisis and Reassessment (1970–1984)

Researchers began questioning the ethics and usefulness of experiments.

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Women and minority groups criticized social psychology for bias.

Stronger ethical standards were introduced.

Researchers increased the use of correlational methods.

Ideas from cognitive psychology greatly influenced social psychology.

The discipline became more inclusive and scientifically rigorous.

Expanded Global View (1985–Present)

Social psychology became a global discipline.

European and Latin American social psychology associations were formed.

Researchers from different countries began collaborating.

Cross-cultural studies became more common.

Research examined whether behavior is influenced by culture or human evolution.

Modern social psychology studies both positive and negative aspects of human behavior.

Applications now include law, health, education, sports, and business.

Important Exam Points

Social psychology is not simply common sense; it uses scientific methods to test ideas.

The "I Knew It All Along" phenomenon is called hindsight bias.

Social psychology focuses on individuals, while sociology focuses on groups and society.

Personality psychology studies individual differences, while social psychology studies social influences.

Human behavior is shaped by both nature and nurture.

Norman Triplett conducted the first social psychology experiment in 1897.

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William McDougall and Edward Ross published the first books on social psychology.

Floyd Allport established social psychology as a scientific discipline.

SPSSI was founded in 1936.

Kurt Lewin is known as one of the most influential social psychologists.

His famous statement was: "**No research without action and no action without research.**"

Theodore Adorno studied the authoritarian personality.

Stanley Milgram is famous for obedience experiments.

Solomon Asch is famous for conformity studies.

Leon Festinger developed the Theory of Cognitive Dissonance (1957).

The five historical periods are Early Years, Coming of Age, Rapid Expansion, Crisis and Reassessment, and Expanded Global View.

Remember: Norman Triplett = First Experiment, Floyd Allport = Scientific Foundation, Kurt Lewin = Father of Modern Social Psychology, Leon Festinger = Cognitive Dissonance Theory. ✓

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 02: Introduction to Social Psychology

1. The belief that "I knew it all along" after learning an outcome is called:

Attribution Error

Social Facilitation

Hindsight Bias ✓

Cognitive Dissonance

Correct Answer: Hindsight Bias

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2. Which discipline mainly focuses on the influence of people on the individual?

Sociology

Anthropology

Social Psychology ✓

Political Science

Correct Answer: Social Psychology

3. Who conducted the first social psychology experiment in 1897?

Kurt Lewin

Leon Festinger

Norman Triplett ✓

Floyd Allport

Correct Answer: Norman Triplett

4. Who developed the Theory of Cognitive Dissonance in 1957?

Stanley Milgram

Leon Festinger ✓

Solomon Asch

Theodore Adorno

Correct Answer: Leon Festinger

5. Which social psychologist is famous for the statement “No research without action and no action without research”?

Floyd Allport

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Norman Triplett

Kurt Lewin ✓

Edward Ross

Correct Answer: Kurt Lewin

Lesson 03: Conducting Research in Social Psychology

Introduction to Research in Social Psychology

Research is essential for understanding social behavior scientifically.

Social psychology uses different research methods to study human thoughts, feelings, and behaviors.

Researchers use systematic procedures to reduce bias and increase accuracy.

Research helps reduce uncertainty and provides reliable information.

What is Scientific Research?

Research is the method of asking and answering questions through systematic procedures.

Research helps researchers avoid personal biases and errors.

Knowledge gained through research reduces uncertainty and ambiguity.

Scientific research is based on evidence rather than personal opinions.

Characteristics of Empirical Research

Empirical research is well-planned.

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Empirical research is controlled for errors.

Empirical research is internally and externally consistent.

Empirical research is replicable, meaning other researchers can repeat it and obtain similar results.

Empirical research is based on observation and evidence.

When Should Research Be Conducted?

Research should be conducted when sufficient time is available.

Research should be conducted when existing information is inadequate.

Research should be conducted when the research question is important.

Research should be conducted when the value of the information exceeds the cost of conducting research.

The benefits of research must be greater than its costs.

Benefits and Costs of Research

Benefits of Research

Research decreases uncertainty.

Research increases the likelihood of making correct decisions.

Research improves relationships, business, health, and performance.

Costs of Research

Research requires financial expenditures.

Research may not always add new knowledge.

Research may sometimes produce incorrect results.

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Social Psychology Research

Research in social psychology is more challenging because human behavior is not directly observable like physical objects.

Social psychologists use creative research methods.

Common research methods include laboratory experiments.

Field studies are used to observe behavior in natural settings.

Surveys and questionnaires are used to collect information.

Archival data can also be used for research purposes.

Scientific Method

The scientific method is the foundation of social psychology research.

It consists of procedures used to gather, analyze, and interpret information.

The scientific method reduces errors and produces reliable conclusions.

It relies on empirical evidence rather than intuition.

It depends on direct observation and experimentation.

It requires systematic explanation of events.

Goals of the Scientific Method

Description

Description involves observing, classifying, and recording events and relationships.

Researchers describe behavior before attempting to explain it.

Description helps organize information systematically.

Prediction

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Prediction involves forecasting future behavior based on observed relationships.

Prediction is often based on correlational findings.

Prediction does not necessarily establish cause and effect.

Understanding

Understanding involves identifying the causes of behavior.

Researchers seek explanations for why events occur.

True understanding requires evidence of causation.

Conditions for Establishing Cause and Effect

Covariation of Events

Variables must change together in a meaningful way.

Time-Order Relationship

The cause must occur before the effect.

Elimination of Alternative Explanations

Other possible causes must be ruled out.

Researchers must ensure that observed effects are not caused by unrelated factors.

Basic Research

Basic research aims to increase knowledge for its own sake.

It focuses on understanding social behavior.

It does not attempt to solve a specific practical problem.

It contributes to scientific theory and knowledge.

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Applied Research

Applied research focuses on solving real-world problems.

It uses existing knowledge to improve society.

It helps address issues related to health, education, business, and social behavior.

Applied research has direct practical applications.

The Research Process

The scientific research process follows a series of systematic steps.

Research begins with identifying a problem and reviewing previous studies.

Researchers then develop theories and hypotheses.

Variables and operational definitions are identified.

An appropriate research design is selected.

Ethical issues are evaluated.

Data are collected and analyzed.

Results are interpreted and reported.

Eight Basic Steps of Research

Develop a Research Question and Review Literature

Develop a Theory or Hypothesis

Identify Variables and Operational Definitions

Choose a Research Design

Evaluate Ethical Issues

Collect Data

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Analyze Data and Draw Conclusions

Report Research Results

Developing a Research Question

Research ideas can come from previous studies.

Research ideas can come from daily life experiences.

Research ideas can come from current events and news.

Research questions should be specific and focused.

Researchers should narrow broad topics into manageable questions.

Scientific theories help generate research questions and hypotheses.

Research questions often reflect the researcher's interests, experiences, and culture.

Sources of Research Questions

Previous research studies.

Real-world events and problems.

Personal experiences.

News reports and current issues.

Scientific theories.

Literature Review

A literature review helps researchers understand previous findings.

Researchers review existing studies before conducting new research.

Previous research helps guide new investigations.

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Modern literature searches are often conducted using electronic databases.

Sources of Literature

Books.

Research articles.

Electronic databases such as PsycINFO.

Unpublished research material.

Important Exam Points

Research is the systematic method of asking and answering questions while avoiding bias.

Empirical research is well-planned, controlled, consistent, and replicable.

Research should be conducted only when its benefits exceed its costs.

Social psychology relies heavily on the scientific method.

The scientific method uses empirical evidence rather than intuition.

The three goals of the scientific method are Description, Prediction, and Understanding.

The three conditions for establishing causation are Covariation, Time-Order Relationship, and Elimination of Alternative Explanations.

Basic research increases knowledge for its own sake.

Applied research focuses on solving practical problems.

The research process consists of eight major steps.

Research questions can come from previous research, real-world problems, personal experiences, and scientific theories.

Important sources of literature include books, research articles, electronic databases, and unpublished materials.

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Remember: Scientific Method = Description + Prediction + Understanding. ✓

Remember: Causation requires Covariation, Time-Order Relationship, and Elimination of Alternative Explanations. ✓

Remember: Basic Research = Knowledge, Applied Research = Problem Solving. ✓

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 03: Conducting Research in Social Psychology

1. Empirical research is best described as research that is:

- Based on personal opinion
- Based on intuition
- Based on observation and evidence
- Based only on theory

Correct Answer: Based on observation and evidence ✓

2. Which of the following is NOT a goal of the scientific method?

- Description
- Prediction
- Understanding
- Guessing

Correct Answer: Guessing ✓

3. Which condition is necessary to establish cause and effect in research?

- Random guessing
- Covariation of events
- Personal belief
- Common sense

Correct Answer: Covariation of events ✓

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4. Basic research in social psychology mainly focuses on:

- Solving real-world problems
- Increasing knowledge for its own sake
- Business profit making
- Treating psychological disorders only

Correct Answer: Increasing knowledge for its own sake ✓

5. The first step in the research process is:

- Collecting data
- Developing a research question and reviewing literature
- Analyzing results
- Reporting findings

Correct Answer: Developing a research question and reviewing literature ✓

Lesson 04: Conducting Research in Social Psychology

Introduction to Research Process

Research in social psychology follows a systematic scientific process.

It helps in understanding human behavior using reliable and controlled methods.

Research begins with selecting a good and meaningful research question.

Researchers must ensure that the question is scientifically important and useful.

The outcome of research should contribute to knowledge and society.

Step 1: Selection of Research Question

A good research question must be clear and meaningful.

It should have scientific importance and practical value.

Researchers should consider the scope of the question.

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Researchers must think about possible outcomes of the study.

The value of research should justify time, effort, and cost.

A question should interest others and contribute to knowledge.

Step 2: Developing Theory and Hypothesis

A theory is a system of ideas that explains relationships between events.

A good theory should be accurate, logical, simple, and useful.

A strong theory can predict behavior effectively.

A good theory should be internally consistent without contradictions.

A good theory should be economical and not overly complex.

A good theory should be fertile, meaning it inspires further research.

A hypothesis is a specific prediction derived from a theory.

Hypotheses are tested through scientific research.

Example: TV violence exposure increases aggression in adulthood.

Relationship Between Theory and Hypothesis

The theory provides explanation of behavior.

The hypothesis provides a testable prediction.

Operational definitions define how variables are measured.

Concepts are converted into measurable variables for testing.

Example: aggression and TV violence must be clearly defined in measurable terms.

Step 3: Variables and Operational Definitions

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Variables are factors that can change and be measured.

Independent variables are manipulated by the researcher.

Dependent variables are the outcomes measured in the study.

Operational definitions describe how variables are measured.

They make abstract concepts measurable and clear.

Example: reinforcement and punishment in Bandura's study were operationally defined.

Step 4: Research Methods

Three main research methods are used in social psychology.

Observational method involves watching behavior directly.

Correlational method studies relationships between variables.

Experimental method tests cause and effect relationships.

Researchers choose methods that reduce error and bias.

Step 5: Ethical Considerations in Research

Research must follow ethical principles and guidelines.

Participants must give informed consent before participation.

Participants should remain anonymous when required.

Researchers must protect participants from harm.

Confidentiality of data must be maintained.

Deception should be minimized and justified if used.

Participants must be debriefed after the study.

Ethical rules ensure safety and trust in research.

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Milgram's Obedience Experiment

Milgram studied obedience to authority.

Participants believed they were giving electric shocks.

The study showed high levels of obedience to authority.

Many participants experienced stress and discomfort.

The study raised serious ethical concerns.

Critics questioned psychological harm to participants.

Milgram argued the study provided valuable scientific insight.

He concluded that people may obey authority even when causing harm.

Step 6: Data Collection

Data collection begins after ethical approval.

A sample is a group selected for the study.

Population is the entire group from which sample is taken.

Results are generalized from sample to population.

Quantitative data is numerical in form.

Qualitative data is descriptive and non-numerical.

Representative samples increase research accuracy.

Sampling Techniques

Simple random sampling gives equal chance to all participants.

Systematic sampling selects every nth participant.

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Stratified sampling ensures representation of all subgroups.

Cluster sampling selects groups instead of individuals.

Multistage sampling uses multiple steps of selection.

Sampling method affects the accuracy of research results.

Important Exam Points

A good research question must be important, clear, and meaningful.

Theory explains relationships while hypothesis tests them.

A hypothesis is a testable prediction derived from theory.

Variables must be clearly defined using operational definitions.

Independent variable is manipulated and dependent variable is measured.

Scientific methods include observational, correlational, and experimental approaches.

Ethical principles include consent, confidentiality, and protection from harm.

Milgram's experiment highlighted major ethical issues in psychology.

Sample represents population and must be carefully selected.

Sampling methods affect validity and generalization of results.

Remember: Good research = Clear Question + Strong Theory + Testable Hypothesis + Ethical Practice + Proper Sampling. ✓

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 04: Conducting Research in Social Psychology

1. A good research question should primarily be:

Based only on personal opinion

Scientifically important and meaningful

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Very simple and unimportant
Random and general

Correct Answer: Scientifically important and meaningful ✓

2. A hypothesis is best defined as:

A final research report
A general observation
A testable prediction derived from a theory
A research sample

Correct Answer: A testable prediction derived from a theory ✓

3. Which of the following is an example of an independent variable?

Outcome of the study
Dependent result
Variable manipulated by the researcher
Population size

Correct Answer: Variable manipulated by the researcher ✓

4. In Milgram's experiment, the main issue raised was related to:

Sampling error
Ethical concerns
Data analysis problems
Theory development

Correct Answer: Ethical concerns ✓

5. Which sampling technique gives every member an equal chance of selection?

Stratified sampling
Cluster sampling
Systematic sampling
Simple random sampling

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Correct Answer: Simple random sampling ✓

Lesson 05: Conducting Research in Social Psychology (Research Process, Designs & Methods)

Step 6: Data Collection

Data collection begins after research approval and sampling decisions.

Non-probability sampling does not guarantee representativeness of the population.

It is mainly used when generalization is not the primary goal.

Purposive sampling selects participants based on specific characteristics.

Accidental sampling selects participants who are easily available.

Convenience sampling uses easily accessible groups and is often biased.

Call-in surveys depend on voluntary participation and are not representative.

Even large samples in call-in surveys may still produce biased results.

Types of Data

Qualitative data is non-numerical and descriptive.

Quantitative data is numerical and measurable.

Both types of data can be used in social psychology research.

Techniques of Data Collection

Self-reports are used to measure attitudes, emotions, and perceptions.

Self-reports depend on participants' own descriptions of internal states.

Direct observation involves recording actual behavior.

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Archival data uses existing records such as newspapers, court records, and documents. These methods can be used separately or together.

Step 7: Data Analysis and Theory Evaluation

After collecting data, researchers analyze it using statistical methods.

Descriptive statistics summarize data from a sample.

Inferential statistics help generalize findings to the population.

Data analysis shows whether hypotheses are supported or rejected.

If hypotheses are not supported, the theory may need revision.

If hypotheses are supported, the theory gains strength and validity.

Step 8: Reporting Research Results

Research findings must be communicated to others.

Research is considered incomplete if it is not reported.

Results are shared through journal publications.

Results are also shared through conferences and presentations.

Researchers may also share findings directly with other scientists.

Parts of a Research Report

A research report includes title and author information.

It includes abstract and introduction sections.

It includes method and results sections.

It includes discussion and conclusion sections.

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It also includes references, tables, and figures.

Appendices and footnotes may also be included.

Research Designs in Social Psychology

Research designs help structure the study of behavior.

Descriptive designs focus on describing behavior.

Group difference designs compare different groups.

Association designs examine relationships between variables.

Types of Group Difference Designs

Independent group designs compare separate groups.

Dependent group designs use the same participants in different conditions.

Repeated measures designs reduce sample size requirements.

Order effects can occur in repeated designs.

Counterbalancing is used to control order effects.

Matched designs use participants with similar characteristics.

Longitudinal and Mixed Designs

Longitudinal designs study changes over time.

They are extended forms of repeated measures designs.

Mixed designs combine independent and dependent group features.

Most Common Research Methods

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Observational research describes behavior without manipulation.

Correlational research examines relationships between variables.

Experimental research studies cause and effect relationships.

Observational Research

Observational research focuses on accurate description of behavior.

Researchers do not manipulate variables.

It is used to record natural behavior in real settings.

It has high validity because it reflects real situations.

It can be time-consuming and resource-intensive.

Types of Observational Methods

Naturalistic observation studies behavior in real environments.

Participant observation involves researcher participation in the group.

Archival research uses existing records and documents.

Essentials of Observation

Functional analysis includes antecedent, behavior, and consequence.

Behavior must be clearly categorized and defined.

Clear operational definitions improve accuracy of observation.

Categories of Aggressive Behavior

Physical aggression includes hitting, kicking, pushing, and punching.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Verbal aggression includes shouting, insulting, and threatening.

Clear categories help in accurate measurement of behavior.

Important Exam Points

Non-probability sampling is often biased and not fully representative.

Data can be qualitative or quantitative in nature.

Descriptive statistics summarize data while inferential statistics generalize results.

Research must be reported through formal scientific channels.

Observational research focuses on behavior without manipulation.

Repeated measures design uses the same participants across conditions.

Counterbalancing reduces order effects in experiments.

Functional analysis includes antecedent, behavior, and consequence.

Longitudinal studies track change over time.

Clear behavioral categories are essential for valid observation.

Remember: Research process = Data collection + Analysis + Interpretation + Reporting. ✓

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 05: Research Process, Designs & Methods

1. Which of the following is a non-probability sampling technique?

Simple random sampling
Stratified sampling
Purposive sampling
Systematic sampling

Correct Answer: Purposive sampling ✓

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

2. Qualitative data refers to data that is:

Numerical and measurable
Based on statistics only
Non-numerical and descriptive
Always experimental

Correct Answer: Non-numerical and descriptive ✓

3. Which type of statistics is used to generalize findings to a larger population?

Descriptive statistics
Inferential statistics
Basic statistics
Random statistics

Correct Answer: Inferential statistics ✓

4. In observational research, the researcher primarily:

Manipulates variables
Changes participant behavior
Records behavior without manipulation
Creates experimental groups

Correct Answer: Records behavior without manipulation ✓

5. Which research design studies change over a long period of time?

Cross-sectional design
Longitudinal design
Experimental design
Correlational design

Correct Answer: Longitudinal design ✓

Lesson 06: Conducting Research in Social Psychology

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Observational Method

Introduction to Observational Method

Observational method is a scientific way of studying behavior by directly observing it.

Researchers do not manipulate variables in this method.

Behavior is studied in its natural or real-life settings.

It helps in understanding behavior in a realistic context.

Essentials of Observation

Operational definitions clearly describe how behaviors are measured.

Compliance means immediately doing what is requested.

Humiliate means intentionally embarrassing or shaming a person.

Behavior can be recorded in terms of frequency, intensity, or duration.

Data recording can be done through diaries, audio, video, or electronic devices.

Validity depends on correct categories and inter-rater reliability.

Inter-rater reliability is also called Kappa correlation.

Types of Observational Methods

The three main types are naturalistic observation, participant observation, and archival research.

Each method is used depending on research goals and context.

Naturalistic Observation

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Naturalistic observation studies behavior in its natural environment.

Researchers remain unobtrusive to avoid influencing behavior.

Sometimes hidden cameras are used to record behavior.

The goal is to observe real-life behavior as it occurs.

Advantages of Naturalistic Observation

It allows observation of behavior in its natural form.

It provides full context for understanding behavior.

It helps in recording rare or unexpected events.

It can be used when laboratory experiments are not possible.

Problems of Naturalistic Observation

Researchers have limited control over variables.

Observer bias may affect interpretation of behavior.

Participants may change behavior if they know they are being observed.

It may raise ethical concerns about privacy invasion.

Conclusions must be made cautiously due to lack of control.

Participant Observation

Participant observation involves the researcher becoming part of the group.

The researcher observes behavior while actively participating.

It allows deeper understanding of social behavior.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Example of Participant Observation

Festinger's study on cognitive dissonance is a famous example.

Researchers observed a doomsday cult believing the world would end.

When the prophecy failed, members justified their beliefs instead of leaving.

This supported cognitive consistency theory.

Advantages of Participant Observation

It allows observation of behavior in real social settings.

It helps understand behavior in full context.

It enables study of rare and unique events.

It allows observation of situations that cannot be ethically created in labs.

Archival Research

Archival research uses existing records to study behavior.

Sources include newspapers, diaries, TV programs, and census data.

It helps study cultural and historical patterns of behavior.

Content Analysis

Content analysis is used to analyze archival data.

Judges independently categorize and count data.

It helps in systematic analysis of written or recorded material.

Example of Archival Research

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Research on TV violence analyzed 2700 TV programs.

Violence was defined as physical force or threat of harm.

Results showed that over 60% of programs contained violence.

Cable channels showed higher violence than public TV.

Most violence was presented in a sanitized or unrealistic way.

Children's programs often showed violence in a humorous context.

Advantages of Archival Research

It uses already available data.

It is cost-effective and time-saving.

It allows study of long-term cultural trends.

It avoids influence of researcher on behavior.

Important Exam Points

Observational method studies behavior without manipulation.

Naturalistic observation studies behavior in real-life settings.

Participant observation involves researcher participation in the group.

Archival research uses existing records and documents.

Observer bias can affect accuracy of results.

Inter-rater reliability improves validity of observations.

Content analysis is used to analyze archival data.

Observational research helps study rare and natural behaviors.

Ethical issues may arise due to privacy concerns.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Remember: Observational methods = Naturalistic + Participant + Archival research.
✓

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 06: Observational Method

1. Naturalistic observation refers to:

Manipulating variables in a lab
Studying behavior in controlled experiments
Observing behavior in its natural environment
Using only surveys for data collection

Correct Answer: Observing behavior in its natural environment ✓

2. In participant observation, the researcher:

Only records data from a distance
Becomes part of the group being studied
Uses only archival records
Does not observe behavior directly

Correct Answer: Becomes part of the group being studied ✓

3. Which of the following is a major problem in observational research?

High cost of experiments
Observer bias
Lack of theories
Too much control over variables

Correct Answer: Observer bias ✓

4. Archival research mainly uses:

New experimental data
Existing records and documents
Laboratory equipment
Random sampling only

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Correct Answer: Existing records and documents ✓

5. Content analysis is a technique used in:

Experimental research
Survey research
Archival research
Laboratory testing only

Correct Answer: Archival research ✓

Lesson 07: Conducting Research in Social Psychology

Correlational Method

Introduction to Correlational Method

Correlational method is a scientific way of studying the relationship between two or more variables.

Researchers do not manipulate variables in this method.

It only examines whether variables are related or not.

It helps in predicting behavior based on relationships between variables.

Nature of Correlational Research

Correlational research studies how variables change together.

If one variable changes, the other may also change.

This relationship is called correlation.

Variables are naturally occurring and not controlled by the researcher.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Correlation Meaning

Correlation shows relationship between variables.

It has two main features:

Direction (positive or negative)

Strength (weak or strong)

Correlation Coefficient (r)

Correlation is measured by a value called r.

It ranges from -1.00 to +1.00.

+1.00 = perfect positive correlation

-1.00 = perfect negative correlation

0 = no correlation

Types of Correlation

Positive correlation means both variables increase together.

Negative correlation means one increases while the other decreases.

Zero correlation means no relationship exists between variables.

Examples of Correlation

Study time and academic performance show positive correlation.

Stress and performance show negative correlation.

Shoe size and intelligence show no correlation.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Correlation and Causation

Correlation does not mean causation.

It cannot explain cause and effect relationships.

Two main problems are involved.

Reverse Causality Problem

It is unclear which variable causes the other.

Example: aggression and TV violence.

We cannot decide direction of cause.

Third Variable Problem

A hidden variable may influence both variables.

Example: ice cream sales and drowning cases.

The hidden variable is hot weather.

Spurious Relationship

A false relationship between two variables.

They appear related but are actually not.

Path Analysis

Path analysis is a statistical method.

It shows direct and indirect relationships between variables.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

It also shows mediating variables.

Example: parental support improves adjustment through coping style.

Surveys

Surveys are a major method of correlational research.

They are used to collect information from people.

They measure attitudes, beliefs, opinions, and behaviors.

Types of Surveys

Face-to-face surveys involve direct interviews.

Written surveys use paper questionnaires.

Telephone surveys are conducted over phone.

Computer surveys are conducted online.

Types of Survey Questions

Closed-ended questions have fixed answers.

Open-ended questions allow free responses.

Closed-ended Questions

These questions are easy to analyze.

Example: Do you use social media? Yes or No.

They limit response options.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Open-ended Questions

These questions give detailed answers.

Example: Why do you use social media?

They take more time to analyze.

Likert Scale

Used to measure attitudes.

It has rating options like:

Strongly disagree to strongly agree.

Usually ranges from 1 to 5.

Sampling in Surveys

Random sampling gives equal chance to all individuals.

It helps in making results generalizable.

Representative sample reflects the whole population.

Problems in Surveys

Social desirability bias affects answers.

People may give socially acceptable responses.

Poor question design reduces accuracy.

Non-random sampling reduces validity.

Questionnaire Design Rules

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Start with easy questions.

Avoid sensitive questions at the beginning.

Use funneling from general to specific.

Avoid double negatives.

Keep questions clear and simple.

Important Exam Points

Correlational method studies relationship, not causation.

Correlation coefficient ranges from -1 to +1.

Correlation does not prove cause and effect.

Reverse causality and third variable are major problems.

Surveys are most common correlational method.

Closed-ended questions are easy to analyze.

Open-ended questions give detailed responses.

Random sampling improves accuracy.

Social desirability bias affects survey results.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 07: Correlational Method

1. Correlational research mainly studies:

- ✓ Relationship between two or more variables
- Manipulated cause-effect relationships
- Only experimental behavior
- Only laboratory behavior

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

2. The correlation coefficient (r) ranges from:

- 0 to 100
 - 10 to +10
 - ✓ -1.00 to +1.00
 - 1 to 5
-

3. A positive correlation means:

- One variable increases while other decreases
 - ✓ Both variables increase or decrease together
 - No relationship exists
 - Variables are manipulated
-

4. The main limitation of correlational research is:

- It is too expensive
 - ✓ It cannot determine cause and effect
 - It has no variables
 - It only uses experiments
-

5. Third variable problem means:

- One variable directly causes another
 - ✓ A hidden variable influences both variables
 - No relationship exists
 - Variables are controlled by researcher
-

Lesson 08: Conducting Research in Social Psychology

Experimental Method

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Introduction to Experimental Method

Experimental method is a scientific way of studying cause-and-effect relationships.

Researchers actively manipulate one variable to observe its effect on another.

It is the most powerful method for determining causality.

It uses controlled conditions for accurate results.

Key Idea of Experiments

Experiments focus on cause and effect relationships.

One variable is changed deliberately by the researcher.

The effect of this change is then measured.

This helps in testing scientific hypotheses.

Independent Variable (IV)

Independent variable is the variable that is manipulated by the researcher.

It is considered the cause in an experiment.

Example: use of highlighters, violence exposure, lighting conditions.

Dependent Variable (DV)

Dependent variable is the variable that is measured.

It is the effect of changes in the independent variable.

Example: performance, aggression, memory scores.

Experimental and Control Groups

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Experimental group receives the treatment or manipulation.

Control group does not receive the treatment.

Both groups are compared to find differences.

This comparison helps establish cause-effect relationships.

Basic Experimental Design

Experiments often use random assignment to divide participants.

Participants are placed into control and experimental groups.

This helps reduce bias and increases validity.

Sampling in Experiments

Convenience samples are often used in psychology research.

Participants are usually students or easily available individuals.

Random assignment is more important than random sampling in experiments.

Example of Experiment

Students are given text to read.

One group uses highlighters, the other does not.

Later both groups take a test.

Difference in scores shows effect of highlighters.

Field Experiments

Field experiments are conducted in real-life settings.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Participants may not know they are being studied.

They have high external validity.

However, researchers have less control over variables.

Laboratory Experiments

Laboratory experiments are conducted in controlled environments.

Researchers control all variables carefully.

They allow strong cause-and-effect conclusions.

However, they may lack realism.

Example of Laboratory Experiment

Study on aggression and violent films.

Participants are exposed to violent or non-violent conditions.

Aggression is measured using shock intensity.

Results show violent media increases aggression.

Complex Experimental Design

Some experiments include more than one independent variable.

Example: anger and violent film exposure.

This allows studying interaction effects.

Combination of variables can increase or decrease behavior.

Interaction Effect

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Interaction occurs when two variables combine to affect behavior.

Example: anger + violent movie leads to highest aggression.

This shows combined influence is stronger than single factors.

Internal Validity

Internal validity means accuracy of cause-and-effect conclusions.

Laboratory experiments usually have high internal validity.

Control over variables improves internal validity.

External Validity

External validity means generalization to real-life situations.

Field experiments have higher external validity.

Because they occur in natural environments.

Realism in Experiments

Experimental realism means participants feel situation is real.

Mundane realism means situation matches real-world conditions.

Both help improve quality of experiments.

Types of Experimental Designs

Independent measures design uses different participants in each group.

Repeated measures design uses same participants in all conditions.

Matched participants design uses similar participants across groups.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Counterbalancing

Used in repeated measures design.

It reduces order effects.

Participants experience conditions in different sequences.

Example: ABBA design.

Strengths of Experimental Method

It shows clear cause-and-effect relationships.

It allows control over variables.

It provides strong scientific evidence.

It supports hypothesis testing.

Limitations of Experimental Method

Sometimes artificial environment reduces realism.

Some variables cannot be ethically manipulated.

Results may not always generalize to real life.

Important Exam Points

Experiments study cause and effect relationships.

Independent variable is manipulated.

Dependent variable is measured.

Control group does not receive treatment.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Experimental group receives treatment.

Random assignment improves validity.

Field experiments = real-life setting.

Lab experiments = controlled setting.

Interaction effects show combined influence of variables.

No single experimental design is perfect for all situations.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 08: Experimental Method

1. Experimental method is mainly used to study:

Observation of behavior in natural settings
Relationships between variables without control
✓ Cause and effect relationships
Survey-based opinions only

Correct Answer: ✓ Cause and effect relationships

2. In an experiment, the variable that is manipulated is called:

Dependent variable
Control variable
✓ Independent variable
Extraneous variable

Correct Answer: ✓ Independent variable

3. The dependent variable in an experiment is:

The variable that is manipulated
✓ The variable that is measured as an effect

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

The variable kept constant
The sampling method used

Correct Answer: ✓ The variable that is measured as an effect

4. Random assignment in experiments helps to:

Increase sample size
✓ Reduce bias and make groups equivalent
Manipulate the dependent variable
Avoid using control groups

Correct Answer: ✓ Reduce bias and make groups equivalent

5. A field experiment is conducted in:

A laboratory setting only
A survey environment
✓ A natural or real-life setting
A computer simulation only

Correct Answer: ✓ A natural or real-life setting

Lesson 09: The Self

The Self in Social Psychology

Introduction to The Self

The self refers to how a person understands and thinks about “who I am.”

It is one of the most important topics in social psychology.

People are highly interested in understanding themselves.

Self is both the subject and object of awareness.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Concept of Self

The self-concept is a person's answer to the question "Who am I?"

It includes thoughts, beliefs, and perceptions about oneself.

It develops through social experiences and interactions.

Self as a Social Being

The self is a symbolic and social being.

It develops through interaction with others.

People understand themselves through social relationships.

The self is not isolated but socially formed.

Self-Schemas

Self-schemas are beliefs about the self.

They organize and guide how we process information about ourselves.

They strongly influence thinking and behavior.

They help us interpret social information related to self.

Twenty Statement Test (TST)

Developed by Kuhn and McPartland (1954).

It is used to measure self-concept.

Participants answer "Who am I?" twenty times.

It reveals how people describe themselves.

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Self and Brain Function

Self-related thinking is linked to the brain.

Frontal lobes of the brain are responsible for self-awareness.

They control thinking, planning, and social behavior.

Anterior cingulate cortex is involved in self-awareness.

Theories of Self

William James and George Herbert Mead are major theorists of self.

Their ideas form the foundation of modern self theories.

They described self as having two parts.

Two Aspects of Self

The self has two components:

“I” → the active thinker and doer.

“Me” → the object of self-knowledge.

“I” is action-based self.

“Me” is reflective self.

Self as Symbol-Using Being

Humans use symbols and language to understand themselves.

Self-awareness allows people to reflect on their behavior.

This ability helps in social adaptation.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

The self evolved to manage social complexity.

Types of Self-Awareness

Self-awareness is of two main types.

Private self-awareness

Public self-awareness

Private Self-Awareness

Private self-awareness is awareness of inner self.

It includes thoughts, feelings, and emotions.

Example: looking in a mirror or feeling pain.

It focuses on internal states.

Public Self-Awareness

Public self-awareness is awareness of how others see us.

It occurs when we are observed by others.

Example: being photographed or speaking in public.

It focuses on external appearance and behavior.

Importance of Self in Psychology

Self helps in understanding personality and behavior.

It influences social interaction and decision-making.

It is central to identity formation.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

It shapes how we interpret social situations.

Important Exam Points

Self-concept = answer to “Who am I?”

Self develops through social interaction.

Self-schemas organize self-related information.

TST measures self-concept using 20 statements.

William James divided self into “I” and “Me.”

Private self = inner awareness.

Public self = awareness of others’ perception.

Frontal lobes are linked with self-awareness.

Self is both biological and social in nature.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 09: The Self

1. The self-concept refers to:

✓ A person’s answer to “Who am I?”

Only physical appearance

Memory of past events only

Social behavior in groups

Correct Answer: ✓ A person’s answer to “Who am I?”

2. Self-schemas are:

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Behavioral reactions to others

✓ Beliefs about the self that guide information processing

Temporary emotions

Types of personality disorders

Correct Answer: ✓ Beliefs about the self that guide information processing

3. The Twenty Statement Test (TST) was developed by:

William James and Mead

✓ Kuhn and McPartland

Freud and Jung

Bandura and Skinner

Correct Answer: ✓ Kuhn and McPartland

4. According to William James, the “I” refers to:

The object of self-knowledge

Social identity only

✓ The active perceiver and doer

Public image of a person

Correct Answer: ✓ The active perceiver and doer

5. Private self-awareness refers to:

✓ Awareness of internal thoughts and feelings

Awareness of others' opinions only

Group identity awareness

Behavior in public situations only

Correct Answer: ✓ Awareness of internal thoughts and feelings

Lesson 10: The Self (Continued)

Development, Self-Regulation, Schemas & Culture

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Development of Self-Awareness

Self-awareness is not inborn.

It develops gradually through stages of life.

Infants (9–12 months) cannot fully recognize themselves in mirrors.

They initially treat mirror image as another child.

By around 18 months, children begin recognizing themselves as separate individuals.

Childhood Development of Self

In childhood, individuals begin labeling personal qualities and abilities.

They start understanding “who I am” in concrete terms.

Self-concept becomes more organized and stable.

Adolescence and Self

During adolescence, self becomes highly important.

It plays a key role in making life decisions.

Identity formation becomes a central psychological task.

Adulthood and Self

In middle and late adulthood, self continues to develop.

Changes are slower but still present.

Self may become more stable over time.

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Effects of Private Self-Awareness

Private self-awareness focuses on inner thoughts and feelings.

It intensifies emotions, making feelings stronger.

It helps clarify personal thoughts and experiences.

It increases adherence to personal standards.

People act more according to internal beliefs.

Effects of Public Self-Awareness

Public self-awareness focuses on how others see us.

It creates evaluation apprehension (fear of judgment).

It may temporarily reduce self-esteem.

People behave more according to social expectations.

It increases concern about appearance and behavior.

Self-Consciousness as a Trait

Self-consciousness is a personality trait.

It refers to the tendency to frequently focus on oneself.

It is different from temporary self-awareness.

Some people are naturally more self-reflective.

Types of Self-Consciousness

Private self-consciousness involves awareness of inner self.

Public self-consciousness involves awareness of outward image.

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Both influence behavior differently.

Advantages of Private Self-Consciousness

It improves self-disclosure in relationships.

It helps early detection of health problems.

It encourages better self-understanding.

It supports personal growth.

Disadvantages of Private Self-Consciousness

It may increase depression and neuroticism.

Excessive self-focus can create emotional distress.

It may lead to overthinking and anxiety.

Distracting activities can reduce negative effects.

Self-Regulation

Self-regulation is the ability to control behavior.

It is linked to the “I” aspect of self.

It helps manage impulses and actions.

It allows delaying small rewards for bigger goals.

TOTE Model of Self-Regulation

TOTE stands for Test–Operate–Test–Exit.

First, we compare behavior with a standard.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Then we try to change behavior if needed.

We test again to check improvement.

We exit when the standard is achieved.

Self-Discrepancy Theory

Self-discrepancy is the gap between actual and ideal self.

It also includes “ought self” (what we should be).

Differences between these selves create emotional distress.

Emotional Consequences

Mismatch with ideal self leads to depression and frustration.

Mismatch with ought self leads to anxiety and guilt.

These are known as dejection and agitation emotions.

Self-Regulation Failure

Negative emotions reduce self-control ability.

People may fail to achieve long-term goals.

Self-control is a limited resource.

After one task, performance on another may decline.

Ego Depletion Concept

Self-control uses mental energy.

After exerting control, energy becomes reduced.

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This leads to weaker self-regulation later.

Example: resisting junk food then losing temper later.

Self-Schemas

Self-schemas are mental structures about self.

They organize self-related information in memory.

They act like cognitive frameworks.

They influence how we interpret experiences.

Self-Schema Importance

We are schematic about traits important to us.

We ignore traits not central to our identity.

Self-schemas shape behavior and thinking.

They guide attention and memory.

Gender Schema

Gender schema is self-based gender identity.

It defines whether a person sees themselves as male or female.

It develops around age 6–7.

It becomes stable after development.

Gender Schema Theory

Children learn gender-based categories.

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They classify behaviors and traits as male or female.

Culture strongly influences gender schemas.

Gender roles shape self-perception.

Culture and Self-Concept

Culture shapes how we define ourselves.

Self-concept differs across societies.

Individualistic cultures focus on personal traits.

Collectivist cultures focus on social roles.

Twenty Statements Test (TST)

TST measures self-concept using “Who am I?” statements.

Responses are classified into categories.

Physical, social, attributive, and global descriptions.

It shows how people define themselves.

Important Exam Points

Self develops from infancy to adulthood.

Private self = inner awareness, stronger emotions.

Public self = social awareness, behavior changes.

Self-regulation uses TOTE model.

Self-discrepancy causes emotional distress.

Self-schemas organize self-knowledge.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Gender schema shapes identity roles.

Culture influences self-concept structure.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 09: The Self

1. The self-concept refers to:

- A person's physical appearance
- A person's answer to "who am I?"
- A person's intelligence level
- A person's social status

Correct Answer: ✓ A person's answer to "who am I?"

2. Self-schemas are:

- ✓ Beliefs about the self that organize self-related information
- Random thoughts about others
- Temporary emotions
- External social rules

Correct Answer: ✓ Beliefs about the self that organize self-related information

3. Private self-awareness occurs when a person is aware of:

- Only public behavior
- ✓ Hidden or internal aspects of self
- Other people's opinions
- Social norms only

Correct Answer: ✓ Hidden or internal aspects of self

4. Public self-awareness leads to:

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Less concern about others

✓ Greater concern about how others evaluate us

No emotional response

Reduced conformity

Correct Answer: ✓ Greater concern about how others evaluate us

5. The “I” in William James’ theory refers to:

Knowledge about self

✓ The active perceiver and initiator of action

Social identity only

Physical self only

Correct Answer: ✓ The active perceiver and initiator of action

Here are your **clean Lesson 11 notes (same pattern, BULLETS removed, order unchanged)** ☐

☐ **Lesson 11: The Self (Continued)**

Culture, Self-Regulation, Biculturalism & Self-Esteem

Introduction

The self is shaped by culture, cognition, and self-regulation.

It is influenced by personal experiences and social environment.

This lecture focuses on cultural differences and evaluation of self.

Negative Effects of Private Self-Consciousness

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Excessive focus on internal self after failure increases distress.
It can intensify negative emotions.
It may lead to unhealthy coping behaviors.
Examples include binge eating and substance abuse.

Self-Destructive Coping Behaviors

People may use harmful behaviors to reduce emotional pain.
Binge eating reduces awareness of distress temporarily.
Substance use may also be used as escape from failure.
These behaviors are linked to self-focus after negative events.

Research Evidence

Hull et al. (1986) found that high self-conscious individuals are more likely to use substances after academic failure.
Self-awareness increases vulnerability to maladaptive coping.

Self-Regulation Theory: Practical Use

Self-regulation can be improved using strategies.
Focus should be on long-term goals instead of short-term emotions.
Identify triggers that lead to unwanted behavior.
Recognize limits of self-control energy.
Avoid overuse of self-control in unrelated tasks.

Implementation Intentions

Implementation intentions are “if-then” plans.
Example: “If situation X occurs, I will do Y.”
They help automate goal-directed behavior.
They improve self-control and decision-making.

Adaptive Self-Regulation

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Sometimes goals cannot be achieved.
People should adjust their goals instead of giving up.
Flexibility improves emotional well-being.
Example: parents coping with illness in children.

Journal Activity: Cultural Influence on Self

Culture strongly shapes how we think and behave.
Cultural background includes religion, ethnicity, family structure, gender roles, food and lifestyle, values and beliefs.
Students reflect on how culture shapes their self-concept.
They also create a self-schema model.

Historical Changes in Self-Concept

Earlier studies show changes in self-description over time.
1950s–60s: self described in social roles.
1970s onward: self described in personal traits.
This shift reflects growing individualism.

Cultural Shift Toward Individualism

Modern Western societies emphasize independence, personal achievement, and self-expression.
This leads to trait-based self-concept.

Individualism vs Collectivism

Individualistic cultures include USA, Canada, and Europe.
They focus on independence, uniqueness, and personal traits.

Collectivist cultures include Asia, Africa, and Latin America.
They focus on group harmony and social roles.

Child Rearing Differences

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Individualist parenting encourages independence and personal success.
Collectivist parenting encourages obedience and group harmony.

Biculturalism

Bicultural individuals belong to two cultures.
They may experience identity conflict.
They balance two cultural identities.

Bicultural Conflict

Conflict occurs when individual goals clash with cultural expectations.
Dual identities may create tension.

Healthy Bicultural Adjustment

Best adjustment occurs when both cultures are maintained and new cultural values are adopted.
This leads to better mental health.

Evaluating the Self (Self-Esteem)

Self-esteem is the evaluative aspect of self.
It refers to how we judge ourselves.
It can be positive or negative.

Effects of Low Self-Esteem

Low self-esteem is linked to depression, pessimism, academic failure, financial problems, and poor health.

Development of Self-Esteem

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Self-esteem develops gradually.
Parents play a major role in early development.
Children integrate feedback from others.

Parenting Styles and Self-Esteem

Authoritative parenting leads to high self-esteem with balanced control and support.
Authoritarian parenting leads to low self-esteem due to strict discipline.
Permissive parenting leads to low confidence due to lack of structure.

Stability of Self-Esteem

Self-esteem is low in childhood, increases in adolescence, stabilizes in adulthood, and declines in old age.

Dark Side of High Self-Esteem

High self-esteem may lead to aggression when challenged, defensive reactions, and narcissistic behavior.

Unstable Self-Esteem

Unstable self-esteem includes a conscious positive self-view and an unconscious negative insecurity.
It leads to emotional instability.

Important Exam Points

Private self-focus can lead to depression and addiction.
Self-regulation improves goal achievement.
Implementation intentions help behavior control.
Culture shapes self-concept strongly.
Individualism vs collectivism affects identity.
Biculturalism requires balance of two cultures.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Self-esteem influences mental and physical health.
Stable self-esteem is healthier than unstable high self-esteem.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 11: The Self (Continued)

1. Excessive private self-consciousness may lead to:

Improved academic performance
Better emotional control
✓ Depression and substance abuse
Increased intelligence

2. Implementation intentions are best described as:

Random behavior plans
✓ If-then plans for goal-directed behavior
Emotional coping strategies only
Memory improvement techniques

3. According to cultural research, collectivist cultures emphasize:

✓ Group harmony and social roles
Personal achievement and independence
Individual uniqueness
Competition and success

4. Bicultural individuals are best described as people who:

Belong to only one culture
Reject all cultural values
✓ Belong to two cultures and may experience identity conflict
Have no cultural identity

5. Self-esteem refers to:

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Memory of past events
Social intelligence level
✓ Evaluation of self as good or bad
Ability to learn new skills

Here are your **clean Lesson 12 notes** (same pattern, BULLETS removed, order unchanged) ☐

☐ **Lesson 12: The Self (Continued)**

Self-Schemas, Possible Selves, Self-Discrepancy & Social Context

Introduction

People in Western culture may have greater difficulty in knowing who they are today than in the past.

Identity was once fixed by family and social position.

Today, people must “discover” their identity due to freedom and mobility.

Many possible selves create confusion about the “real me.”

Modern people often struggle with self-fulfillment and self-actualization.

Personal Identity vs Social Identity

Personal identity refers to individual traits independent of others.

Social identity refers to group membership and social relationships.

Modern Western cultures emphasize personal identity more than social identity.

Traditional cultures emphasize social identity more than personal identity.

Reflecting on Individual Characteristics

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

People understand themselves by reflecting on internal characteristics.
This process does not require interaction with others.
It includes self-schemas, self-complexity, possible selves, and self-discrepancies.

Self-Schemas

Self-schemas are cognitive frameworks used to understand the self.
They organize personality traits, values, attitudes, and behaviors.
They help us interpret who we are.

Some people are schematic for certain traits and aschematic for others.
Schematic individuals strongly define themselves in a trait (e.g., independence).
Aschematic individuals do not consider that trait important in their identity.

Self-schemas also apply to traits like masculinity, femininity, introversion, and body image.

Self-Complexity

Self-complexity refers to the number of dimensions in a self-concept.
Some people define themselves using few dimensions.
Others define themselves using many roles and traits.

Low self-complexity leads to stronger emotional reactions to success or failure.
High self-complexity buffers against stress and depression.
People with complex selves are more emotionally stable.

Possible Selves

Possible selves are future-oriented self-images.
They include expected, desired, and feared selves.
They represent what we might become or fear becoming.

Possible selves influence motivation and behavior.
Positive possible selves increase persistence and performance.
Negative possible selves can also motivate improvement.

Future selves may differ greatly from present selves.
People may have many or few imagined future identities.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Self-Discrepancies

Self-discrepancy theory includes actual self, ideal self, and ought self.

Actual self is who we are.

Ideal self is who we want to be.

Ought self is who we think we should be.

Each self can be viewed from personal or other people's perspective.

Ideal self develops from parental rewards and approval.

Ought self develops from punishment and rules.

Emotional Consequences of Self-Discrepancy

Mismatch between actual and ideal self leads to sadness and dejection.

Mismatch between actual and ought self leads to anxiety and agitation.

These emotional reactions are different depending on the type of discrepancy.

Using Social Context

People understand themselves by comparing with others.

Social context plays a key role in identity formation.

Two main processes are social comparison and self-distinctiveness.

Social Comparison

Social comparison is evaluating oneself using others as a standard.

It is used when no objective standard is available.

People compare themselves with similar or different others.

Upward comparison is comparing with better individuals.

It can reduce or improve self-esteem depending on interpretation.

Downward comparison is comparing with worse individuals.

It can increase self-esteem by making one feel superior.

The effect depends on the goal of comparison, such as improvement or self-protection.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Social Comparison Effects

Upward comparison can motivate improvement or cause dissatisfaction.
Downward comparison can increase confidence or create false superiority.
People choose comparisons that protect self-esteem when possible.

Self-Distinctiveness

Self-distinctiveness refers to being aware of how we are different from others.
People define themselves based on what makes them unique.

A trait becomes part of self-concept when it is rare in the environment.
For example, age or gender becomes more important when it is distinctive.

Self-concept depends on comparison with surrounding social groups.

Important Exam Points

Self is shaped by both internal reflection and social comparison.
Self-schemas organize knowledge about personality and identity.
Self-complexity reduces emotional impact of failure.
Possible selves influence motivation and future behavior.
Self-discrepancy leads to emotional distress (sadness or anxiety).
Social comparison helps define self in absence of objective standards.
Upward and downward comparisons affect self-esteem differently.
Self-distinctiveness highlights traits that make us unique.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 12: The Self (Continued)

1. Self-schemas are best defined as:

A type of memory loss

✓ Cognitive frameworks used to understand the self

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Social comparison strategies
Emotional reactions to failure

2. Self-complexity refers to:

Number of friends a person has
✓ Number of dimensions used to define the self
Level of intelligence
Strength of self-esteem

3. Possible selves include:

Only past identities
✓ Expected, desired, and feared future selves
Only present self-concepts
Social group identities only

4. Upward social comparison means comparing oneself with:

Worse individuals
✓ Better individuals
Same-level individuals only
Imaginary persons

5. Self-distinctiveness refers to:

Being similar to others
✓ Being aware of how we are different from others
Ignoring social comparisons
Having low self-awareness

Lesson 13: Person Perception

How People Perceive Others

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Introduction

Person perception refers to how people understand and interpret others. It includes how we judge emotions, intentions, traits, and abilities of others.

Person perception is not a single process but includes impression formation and attribution.

Practical Implications from Self Lectures

Negative self-consciousness can lead to self-destructive behavior.
Self-regulation depends on cues, mental energy, and self-control strategies.
High self-esteem is positive but has a dark side.
Upward and downward comparisons influence self-view.
Reducing self-discrepancies improves emotional well-being.

Case Example: Stephen Glass

Stephen Glass appeared honest, intelligent, and ethical.
He was a successful journalist with strong impressions among colleagues.

Later investigations showed that many of his stories were fabricated.
This revealed a gap between impression and reality.

This case shows how people manage impressions and how others form judgments about them.

Person Perception

Person perception is the process of understanding others' internal states and traits. It includes emotions, intentions, beliefs, and personality characteristics.

It is a continuous process rather than a single judgment.

It includes two main components: impression formation and attribution.

Impression Formation

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Impression formation is how we create overall judgments about others.
It is based on observable behaviors and nonverbal cues.

It involves integrating different pieces of information into one judgment.
It is dynamic and updated with new information.

Attribution Process

Attribution is the process of explaining why people behave in certain ways.
It goes beyond current behavior and tries to predict future behavior.

It helps us understand causes behind actions.

Nonverbal Behavior in Impression Formation

First impressions are strongly influenced by nonverbal communication.
Nonverbal communication includes gestures, facial expressions, and body movements.

It does not rely on spoken words.

Facial Expressions

Facial expressions are important signals of emotion.
Darwin suggested that emotional expressions are universal and inborn.

Research supports the idea that emotions are recognized across cultures.

Seven basic emotions include anger, fear, happiness, sadness, surprise, disgust, and contempt.

People detect threatening faces faster than non-threatening ones.

Body Movements

Body posture and movement also influence impressions.
Firm handshakes are associated with confidence and extraversion.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Physical touch can create comfort and emotional connection.
Touch is also important in therapy and healing contexts.

Body shapes and movements can signal intentions such as threat or warmth.

Nonconscious Mimicry

Nonconscious mimicry is the automatic imitation of others' behavior.
People copy gestures, posture, and expressions without awareness.

Even infants show early forms of mimicry.

Brain studies show mirror neurons activate when observing others.

Mimicry increases liking and positive social reactions.

People tend to like those who imitate their behavior.

Visible Nonverbal Channels

Visible channels include facial expressions, gestures, posture, appearance, and eye contact.

Eye contact shows interest but varies across cultures.

Paralinguistic Cues

Paralinguistic cues include tone, pitch, speed, and voice quality.
They are not related to words but to how something is spoken.

A warm and attractive voice is usually perceived as more friendly and strong.

Important Exam Points

Person perception helps us understand others' traits and emotions.
Impression formation is based on nonverbal cues and continuous updating.
Attribution explains causes of behavior.
Facial expressions are universal signals of emotion.
Body language influences judgments of personality.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Mimicry increases liking and social bonding.
Nonverbal communication includes visible and paralinguistic cues.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 12: The Self (Continued)

1. Self-schemas are:

- A type of emotional reaction
 - ✓ Cognitive structures that organize knowledge about the self
 - A form of social punishment
 - Random thoughts about others
-

2. Self-complexity refers to:

- ✓ The number of different dimensions used to define the self
 - Level of intelligence of a person
 - Strength of memory
 - Amount of social interaction
-

3. Possible selves include:

- Only past experiences
 - ✓ Expected, desired, and feared future selves
 - Only present identity
 - Only group identities
-

4. Upward social comparison means comparing oneself with:

- Worse-performing individuals
 - ✓ Better-performing individuals
 - Same-level individuals only
 - Fictional characters
-

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

5. Self-distinctiveness refers to:

- Being identical to others in a group
 - ✓ Awareness of how one is different from others
 - Avoiding self-reflection
 - Focusing only on emotions
-

Here are 5 MCQs for Lesson 13 (Person Perception) in the same pattern ☐

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 13: Person Perception

1. Person perception refers to:

- Understanding objects only
 - ✓ Understanding others' emotions, traits, and intentions
 - Memory of past events
 - Learning language rules
-

2. Impression formation is mainly based on:

- Logical reasoning only
 - ✓ Quick judgments using observable cues
 - Mathematical analysis
 - Long-term planning
-

3. Facial expressions are considered:

- ✓ Universal and inborn signals of emotion
 - Completely learned behaviors
 - Random body movements
 - Culturally irrelevant signals
-

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

4. Nonconscious mimicry refers to:

- ✓ Automatic imitation of others' behavior without awareness
 - Conscious copying of behavior
 - Ignoring others' actions
 - Teaching behavior to others
-

5. Paralinguistic cues include:

- ✓ Pitch, tone, and rate of speech
 - Written grammar rules
 - Facial expressions only
 - Body posture only
-

Lesson 14: Person Perception (Continued)

Gender, Culture, Traits & Impression Formation

Introduction

Person perception refers to how we understand and evaluate other people.

It includes forming impressions and making judgments about others.

These impressions are influenced by gender, culture, traits, and nonverbal cues.

Gender Socialization

Gender socialization refers to learning behaviors and expectations based on gender roles.

A social role is a set of expectations defined by society for individuals in a category.

Men and women are taught different emotional and behavioral roles.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

These roles shape how others perceive them and how they behave.

Emotional Styles in Gender

Femininity is associated with extravagant expressiveness.

This involves open expression of emotions.

Masculinity is associated with controlled emotional expression.

This shows emotional strength and self-control.

Cultural Meaning of Emotional Styles

Controlled emotion in men is often linked with independence and rationality.

Expressive emotion in women is often linked with nurturance and care.

In many cultures, masculine emotional style is valued more.

Gender Differences in Emotion Expression

Boys are encouraged to show anger, pride, and dominance-related emotions.

Girls are encouraged to show empathy, happiness, and vulnerability.

These patterns shape personality development and social perception.

Gender Differences in Nonverbal Skills

Research shows women are generally better at decoding nonverbal cues.

Meta-analysis found women outperform men in reading emotional expressions.

Women are especially skilled in recognizing facial expressions.

Men are more likely to express anger effectively.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Cultural Differences in Nonverbal Behavior

Culture strongly shapes nonverbal communication.

Different cultures have different rules for expressing emotions.

Collectivist cultures restrict negative emotional expression in public.

Individualist cultures allow more open emotional expression.

Cultural Differences in Gestures

Handshake styles vary across cultures.

Firm handshake in North America is linked with confidence.

In some Asian and Middle Eastern cultures, a gentle handshake is preferred.

Japanese culture uses bowing instead of handshakes.

Touch and Space Differences

Americans are moderately touch-oriented compared to other cultures.

Asians generally prefer less physical touch.

North Americans prefer about 30 inches personal space.

Middle Eastern cultures prefer closer distance.

Eye contact meanings also vary across cultures.

Eye Contact Differences

In North America, eye contact shows confidence and honesty.

In some Asian and traditional cultures, direct eye contact may be seen as disrespectful.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Gender norms may discourage direct eye contact in females in traditional societies.

Personality and Culture in Impression Formation

Collectivist cultures encourage behavior that maintains group harmony.

Individualist cultures encourage personal expression.

Collectivists avoid expressing negative emotions publicly.

This affects how people form impressions of others.

Central Traits in Impression Formation

People form impressions based on key personality traits.

Some traits influence overall impression more than others.

Warm and cold are examples of central traits.

Peripheral traits have less influence on impression formation.

Asch's Central Traits Theory

Asch showed that certain traits change overall impressions.

A "warm" person is seen more positively overall.

A "cold" person is seen more negatively overall.

People do not simply add traits; they interpret them holistically.

Implicit Personality Theory

People believe certain traits go together.

This belief system is called implicit personality theory.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

It helps us predict others' behavior.

It can also lead to biased judgments.

Evaluative Consistency Principle

People prefer consistent impressions of others.

They try to view others as either mostly good or mostly bad.

Contradictory information is often ignored or explained away.

Positivity Bias

People generally evaluate others in a positive way.

We tend to form favorable impressions of individuals.

This bias makes us initially trust others.

Negativity Effect

Negative traits have stronger impact than positive traits.

People give more attention to negative information.

This is because negative traits are more noticeable.

It helps in detecting threats in social environment.

Primacy Effect

First information about a person has the strongest impact.

Early impressions shape later interpretation of behavior.

Later information is often ignored if it conflicts.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Recency Effect

Recent information can also influence impressions.

It happens when people are warned to avoid bias.

It overrides primacy effect in some conditions.

Averaging Principle

People combine traits by averaging rather than adding them.

Important traits are given more weight.

Final impression depends on weighted evaluation.

Halo Effect

A positive impression in one area influences other judgments.

A liked person is assumed to have other good qualities.

It creates biased but consistent impressions.

Nonverbal Communication in Impression Formation

Facial expressions are universal indicators of emotion.

Body language gives clues about personality and intentions.

Nonconscious mimicry increases liking between people.

Mirror neurons support automatic imitation behavior.

Importance of Culture and Gender

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Culture shapes emotional expression and perception.

Gender influences decoding of nonverbal behavior.

Both affect how impressions are formed in social situations.

Important Exam Points

Person perception includes impression formation and attribution.

Gender roles influence emotional expression styles.

Women are better at decoding nonverbal cues.

Culture shapes gestures, space, and eye contact.

Central traits strongly influence impressions.

Implicit personality theory guides trait assumptions.

Primacy effect is stronger than recency effect.

Halo effect creates biased positive impressions.

Negativity effect increases attention to bad traits.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 14: Person Perception (Continued)

1. Person perception refers to:

The process of learning mathematics

✓ Understanding and forming impressions of others

Only memory recall about people

Judging only physical appearance

2. Central traits in impression formation are those that:

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Have no effect on judgment

✓ Strongly influence overall impression of a person

Are always negative traits

Only describe physical appearance

3. Implicit personality theory refers to:

Scientific classification of personalities

✓ Beliefs about which traits tend to go together

A type of therapy for personality disorders

Memory loss in social perception

4. The primacy effect means:

Last information is most important

✓ First information has greater influence on impression

All information has equal importance

Only negative traits are remembered

5. Nonconscious mimicry refers to:

Deliberate imitation of others

✓ Automatic imitation of others' behaviors without awareness

Forgetting others' behavior quickly

Analyzing personality traits logically

Lesson 15: Person Perception

When Person Perception Is Most Challenging

Introduction

Person perception becomes difficult when information is unclear, misleading, or strongly biased by appearance.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Although we usually form impressions quickly and automatically, accuracy is not always guaranteed.

Two major situations make person perception especially challenging: perceiving baby-faced individuals and detecting lies.

Link with Previous Lectures

We first categorize people based on age, sex, race, or other visible features.

These categories shape our initial impressions.

New information is then interpreted in line with these first impressions.

Sometimes we revise our impressions, but often we rely heavily on categories.

Person perception is therefore often category-based rather than fully individual-based.

Nonverbal cues like voice, face, and body language also shape impressions strongly.

Accuracy in Person Perception

Accuracy means agreement between perceivers, targets, or real behavior prediction.

People are more accurate in judging evolutionarily important traits.

Accuracy does not necessarily improve with familiarity over time.

Bias in Impression Formation

Order of information affects impressions strongly.

Early information has more impact than later information (primacy effect).

People interpret new information to fit initial impressions.

Implicit personality theories also shape judgments about others.

People assume certain traits are linked together.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Cultural Influence on Emotion Perception

Different cultures have different rules for expressing emotions (display rules).

This affects how accurately we interpret others' emotions.

Some emotions are easily faked, making perception harder.

Women are generally better at decoding emotional expressions.

When Person Perception Is Most Challenging

Person perception is especially difficult in two situations:

Perceiving baby-faced individuals

Detecting lies

Perceiving Baby-Faced Individuals

Baby-faced people have features like large eyes, small chin, and soft facial structure.

These features trigger perceptions of innocence and dependency.

Humans are biologically prepared to respond to baby-like features with care and protection.

Stability of Baby-Face Perception

Agreement exists across people about who is baby-faced.

Baby-face features remain relatively stable across development in many individuals.

However, changes may occur with age and sex differences.

Self-Fulfilling Effects

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Baby-faced individuals may start behaving according to how others treat them.

If treated as less competent, they may internalize those expectations.

This is known as self-fulfilling prophecy.

Perceived Traits of Baby-Faced Individuals

Baby-faced people are seen as:

Warm and honest

But also weak and less competent

These perceptions are consistent across cultures.

Behavioral Consequences of Baby-Face Bias

People speak more gently to baby-faced individuals.

Teachers may simplify instructions for them.

They are often treated like children in social interactions.

Occupational Bias

Baby-faced individuals are preferred for jobs requiring warmth.

Mature-faced individuals are preferred for leadership roles.

This shows appearance influences hiring decisions.

Legal System Bias

Baby-faced defendants are judged differently in court.

They may receive leniency for intentional harm.

But may be blamed more for accidental harm.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

This creates a double standard in justice.

Summary of Baby-Face Effects

Baby-faced individuals are treated as:

Warm and trustworthy

But also less competent and less powerful

These biases influence education, work, media, and legal judgments.

Detecting Lies

Lie detection is important in law, relationships, and social interaction.

However, humans are not very accurate lie detectors.

Lying is common because it can be socially and personally beneficial.

Why Lies Are Hard to Detect

People show a truth bias and assume honesty.

Most behavior is accepted at face value.

Questioning others may create social discomfort.

Channels of Deception

Lies can be detected through:

Verbal cues

Vocal cues

Nonverbal cues

Physiological cues

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Nonverbal Leakage

True emotions often “leak” through body behavior.

The face can be controlled more easily than the body.

Therefore, body cues are often more reliable than facial cues.

Common Signs of Lying

Liars may:

Blink more

Hesitate

Make speech errors

Speak in higher pitch

Show pupil dilation

Verbal Cues of Deception

Liars may use:

Negative or vague statements

Irrelevant details

Overgeneralization

Psychological distancing

Vocal Cues of Deception

Liars may show:

Speech hesitation

Higher pitch

Long pauses

Slow speech

Speech errors

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Visual Cues of Deception

Possible indicators include:

- Avoiding eye contact
- Fidgeting
- Posture shifts
- Lack of smiling
- Adaptor movements

However, many of these cues are not always reliable.

Cultural Differences in Lie Detection

Display rules differ across cultures.

This makes cross-cultural lie detection difficult.

What looks like deception in one culture may be normal in another.

Accuracy in Lie Detection

People who focus on nonverbal cues are more accurate.

People focusing only on verbal cues are less accurate.

Face alone is often misleading.

Body movements are more informative.

Research Findings

Studies show trained observers detect lies better than average people.

Judges focusing on body cues perform better than those focusing on faces.

Emotional leakage helps reveal hidden feelings.

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Important Exam Points

Person perception is often category-based.

Baby-faced individuals are judged as warm but less competent.

Baby-face bias affects jobs, education, and legal decisions.

Lie detection is difficult due to truth bias.

Nonverbal cues are more reliable than facial cues alone.

Body language is a key indicator of deception.

Culture strongly affects emotional expression and interpretation.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 15: Person Perception (Most Challenging Cases)

1. Person perception becomes most challenging in which situations?

When people are familiar

✓ When perceiving baby-faced individuals and detecting lies

Only in academic settings

When people are attractive

2. Baby-faced individuals are generally perceived as:

Aggressive and dominant

✓ Warm but less competent

Highly intelligent only

Untrustworthy and cold

3. A primacy effect in impression formation means:

Last information is most important

✓ First information has stronger impact on impressions

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

All information is equally weighted
Only negative traits matter

4. Truth bias in lie detection refers to:

People assume everyone is lying
✓ People generally assume others are telling the truth
People always detect lies correctly
People ignore all verbal cues

5. Which cue is considered most reliable in detecting deception?

Facial expressions only
Verbal statements only
✓ Body movements and nonverbal leakage
Eye color changes

Lesson 16: Attribution

Causal Judgment and Attribution Theories

Introduction

Attribution is the process of explaining why people behave the way they do.

It involves making causal judgments about behavior and events.

Attribution theory focuses on how people answer “why” questions in everyday life.

What is Attribution?

Attribution refers to how people interpret causes of behavior.

It explains how individuals assign meaning to actions and outcomes.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

People try to understand whether behavior is caused by personal or situational factors.

Early Theorists of Attribution

Gustav Ichheiser and Fritz Heider were early contributors to attribution theory.

Heider is considered the founder of attribution theory.

Heider emphasized that people act like “naive scientists” in understanding behavior.

Fritz Heider's Theory

Heider proposed that humans have two basic needs:

The need to understand the world in an organized way

The need to control and predict their environment

To satisfy these needs, people analyze behavior logically.

Locus of Causality

Locus of causality refers to where the cause of behavior is located.

There are two main types:

Internal attribution refers to causes inside the person such as personality, ability, or effort.

External attribution refers to causes outside the person such as situation, luck, or other people.

Stability Dimension (Weiner)

Weiner added stability as an important attribution dimension.

Stable causes are long-lasting and consistent.

Unstable causes are temporary and changeable.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Causes can be internal or external, and stable or unstable.

Controllability Dimension

Weiner also introduced controllability.

Controllable causes can be influenced by the person.

Uncontrollable causes cannot be changed by the person.

These dimensions help explain success and failure.

Combined Attribution Dimensions

Attributions can be:

Internal and stable
Internal and unstable
External and stable
External and unstable

These combinations help explain complex behaviors.

Correspondent Inference Theory

This theory explains how people infer personality traits from behavior.

People assume behavior reflects stable internal traits.

People prefer dispositional explanations because they help predict future behavior.

When We Make Dispositional Attributions

People are more likely to make dispositional attributions when:

Behavior is socially undesirable
Behavior is freely chosen
Behavior has unique or non-common effects

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These conditions strengthen trait-based judgments.

Covariation Model (Kelley)

Kelley's model explains attribution using multiple observations.

It focuses on how causes and effects vary together over time and situations.

A cause is considered valid if it appears when behavior occurs and disappears when behavior does not occur.

Key Idea of Covariation

People compare multiple situations to decide causes.

The most consistent cause across situations is selected as explanation.

Attributions can be internal or external depending on patterns of information.

Types of Information in Covariation Model

Consensus information refers to how others behave in the same situation.

Consistency information refers to whether the same person behaves the same way over time.

Distinctiveness information refers to whether the behavior occurs only in one situation.

Importance of Information Types

People rely more on consistency and distinctiveness than consensus.

We focus more on the individual than on group behavior.

This leads to stronger personal attributions.

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Discounting Principle

If multiple causes are possible, the influence of one cause is reduced.

For example, success during illness reduces internal attribution.

People do not fully credit personality when external causes exist.

Augmentation Principle

If a behavior occurs despite obstacles, internal attribution is strengthened.

Success despite difficulty increases perceived ability or effort.

It enhances dispositional judgments.

Example: Academic Achievement

Success or failure can be explained by:

Effort (internal and controllable)

Mood (internal and uncontrollable)

Task difficulty (external and stable)

Luck (external and unstable)

Example: Stephen Glass Case

Attribution models can explain behavior patterns.

If behavior is consistent across situations, it suggests dispositional causes.

If behavior depends on context, it suggests situational causes.

Glass's fabricated stories can be explained using covariation analysis.

Key Strength of Covariation Model

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It explains behavior using multiple sources of information.

It considers consistency, consensus, and distinctiveness together.

It provides a systematic way of understanding causes.

Important Exam Points

Attribution explains causes of behavior.

Heider introduced internal and external attributions.

Weiner added stability and controllability dimensions.

Correspondent inference focuses on personality traits.

Covariation model uses multiple observations.

Consensus, consistency, and distinctiveness guide attribution.

Discounting reduces importance of one cause.

Augmentation increases importance of effort under difficulty.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 16: ATTRIBUTION (Challenging Cases)

1. Baby-faced individuals are usually perceived as:

Aggressive and dominant

✓ Warm but less competent

Highly intelligent and powerful

Cold and unfriendly

2. Baby-faced appearance is mainly characterized by:

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Sharp jaw and small eyes

✓ Large eyes, small chin, and thin eyebrows

Thick eyebrows and large nose

Deep wrinkles and narrow eyes

3. One major difficulty in lie detection is:

People always tell the truth

✓ People have a truthfulness bias

Liars never show body cues

Facial expressions are always fake

4. Which cue is MOST useful in detecting deception?

Facial expressions only

✓ Body movements and nonverbal leakage

Eye color changes

Handwriting style

5. Baby-faced defendants are more likely to receive:

Harsher punishment for all crimes

✓ More lenient punishment for intentional harm

Equal punishment in all cases

Maximum punishment in negligent crimes only

Lesson 17: Attribution Errors

Biases in Causal Judgment

Introduction

Attribution errors refer to systematic mistakes people make while explaining behavior and events.

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Although people sometimes act like “naive scientists,” their judgments are often biased.

These biases lead to incorrect assumptions about why people behave the way they do.

Biases in Attribution

Attribution is not always logical or accurate.

People often rely on shortcuts that lead to errors in judgment.

These errors affect how we understand ourselves and others.

Fundamental Attribution Error

The fundamental attribution error is the tendency to overestimate internal causes and underestimate situational causes for others' behavior.

People focus more on personality and ignore external conditions.

This leads to biased interpretations of behavior.

Example of Fundamental Attribution Error

In experiments like the quiz show study, observers rated quizmasters as more knowledgeable even when roles were random.

This shows how easily people assume dispositional causes.

Causes of Fundamental Attribution Error

People automatically make dispositional judgments.

They focus on the most visible person in a situation.

They need quick explanations to predict behavior.

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Perceptual Salience

Perceptual salience means the most noticeable person in a situation gets more attention.

Because the actor stands out, observers assume behavior is caused by personality.

Situational factors are ignored.

Cultural Differences

Fundamental attribution error is stronger in individualist cultures.

Collectivist cultures consider situational factors more often.

Cultural learning influences attribution style.

Actor-Observer Bias

The actor-observer bias is the tendency to explain our own behavior using situational causes but others' behavior using dispositional causes.

Actors see situations, observers see persons.

Explanation of Actor-Observer Bias

Actors have more personal information about their situation.

Observers focus only on visible behavior.

Different perspectives create different explanations.

False Consensus Effect

The false consensus effect is the tendency to overestimate how common our own behavior and opinions are.

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People believe others think and act like them.

This creates biased social perception.

Reasons for False Consensus Effect

People interact mostly with similar others.

Own behavior is more accessible in memory.

People assume their behavior is normal.

People are motivated to see themselves as typical.

Self-Serving Attribution Bias

The self-serving attribution bias is the tendency to take credit for success and blame external factors for failure.

Success is linked to internal causes.

Failure is linked to external causes.

This protects self-esteem.

Explanations of Self-Serving Bias

People want to maintain positive self-image.

People expect success and blame external factors when expectations fail.

It helps maintain motivation.

Ultimate Attribution Error

The ultimate attribution error refers to attributing positive behavior of one's own group to internal causes and negative behavior of other groups to internal causes.

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Out-group success is attributed to external causes.

This leads to group bias.

Accuracy in Attribution

People are sometimes accurate in judging observable behavior.

They are less accurate in judging internal thoughts and emotions.

Attribution is often influenced by bias rather than logic.

Implications of Attribution Errors

Attribution errors affect decision-making in everyday life.

They influence judgments in relationships, workplaces, and legal decisions.

They can lead to unfair blame or praise.

Social Consequences

Dispositional attributions can increase punishment for others.

Situational attributions can increase sympathy.

Attributions influence legal judgments and social attitudes.

Cultural Influence on Errors

Individualist cultures show stronger dispositional bias.

Collectivist cultures consider context more.

Culture shapes how people explain behavior.

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Important Exam Points

- Attribution errors distort causal judgments.
 - Fundamental attribution error overemphasizes personality.
 - Actor-observer bias differs for self and others.
 - False consensus effect overestimates similarity.
 - Self-serving bias protects self-esteem.
 - Ultimate attribution error favors in-group judgments.
 - Culture influences attribution patterns.
-

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 17: Attribution Errors

1. The fundamental attribution error refers to:

- Attributing our own behavior to external causes
 - ✓ Overestimating internal causes and underestimating situational causes for others' behavior
 - Attributing all behavior to luck
 - Ignoring personality traits completely
-

2. The actor–observer bias means:

- Observers explain their own behavior internally
 - ✓ Actors use situational causes, while observers use dispositional causes
 - Both actors and observers use situational causes
 - Neither actors nor observers make attributions
-

3. The false consensus effect refers to:

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Believing others are very different from us

✓ Overestimating how much others share our beliefs and behaviors

Assuming all behavior is caused by personality

Ignoring social influence

4. The self-serving attribution bias occurs when people:

Blame themselves for success and failure

✓ Take credit for success but blame external factors for failure

Blame others for their success

Avoid making attributions completely

5. The ultimate attribution error involves:

Explaining all behavior using external causes

✓ Attributing in-group success internally and out-group success externally

Attributing only individual behavior correctly

Ignoring group differences in behavior

Here are same-pattern clean notes for Lesson 18 (Social Cognition) ☐

☐ Lesson 18: Social Cognition

Cognitive Processes in Understanding the Social World

Introduction

Social cognition refers to how people analyze, interpret, remember, and use information about others and the social world.

It explains how individuals make sense of social situations and form judgments.

It focuses on mental processes involved in understanding people and events.

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What is Social Cognition?

Social cognition is the way we process social information to form impressions and decisions.

It helps us understand behavior, intentions, and social situations.

It allows people to respond effectively in social environments.

Dual-Process Models of Social Cognition

Social cognition operates through two systems.

Explicit cognition involves conscious, deliberate, and controlled thinking.

Implicit cognition involves automatic, fast, and unconscious processing.

Both systems work together in social judgment.

How We Organize Social Information

People form quick impressions using limited information.

They rely on mental structures instead of analyzing every detail.

They use categories and schemas to simplify social understanding.

Social Categorization

Social categorization is the process of placing people into groups based on shared characteristics.

It helps reduce complexity in social perception.

Common categories include age, gender, and race.

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Categories and Prototypes

Categories are mental groupings of similar objects or people.

Prototypes are the most typical or representative members of a category.

People compare others to prototypes when categorizing them.

Less typical members are harder to categorize accurately.

Schemas

Schemas are organized mental structures that represent knowledge about concepts, people, and events.

They help people interpret and predict social behavior.

Event schemas are called scripts.

When schemas apply to groups, they may become stereotypes.

Advantages of Schemas

Schemas help in processing information quickly.

They improve memory and recall of information.

They guide interpretation of social events.

They provide expectations about others.

They help in making automatic inferences.

Cognitive Miser Concept

People act as cognitive misers by conserving mental effort.

They prefer simple thinking strategies instead of complex analysis.

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They use shortcuts to make quick judgments.

This helps manage limited cognitive resources.

Heuristics in Social Cognition

Heuristics are mental shortcuts used to make decisions quickly.

They simplify complex judgments into easy rules of thumb.

They are efficient but can sometimes lead to errors.

Representativeness Heuristic

People judge others based on how similar they are to a prototype.

If someone matches a category stereotype, they are placed in that category.

Base-rate information is often ignored.

This leads to base-rate fallacy.

Availability Heuristic

People judge frequency or likelihood based on how easily examples come to mind.

Events that are memorable or dramatic are judged as more common.

Ease of recall influences judgment.

Anchoring and Adjustment Heuristic

People rely heavily on the first piece of information they receive.

This initial value acts as an anchor.

Final judgments are adjusted from this starting point.

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Adjustments are often insufficient.

Example of Anchoring

Initial numbers influence later estimates even when irrelevant.

People remain biased toward the first value they see.

Importance of Social Cognition

Social cognition helps people understand complex social environments.

It allows quick decision-making in daily life.

It improves social interaction and adaptation.

Important Exam Points

Social cognition is the study of how people process social information.

It includes explicit and implicit cognition.

People use categories and schemas to organize information.

Schemas guide memory, interpretation, and expectations.

Cognitive miser means using mental shortcuts to save effort.

Heuristics simplify decision-making.

Representativeness leads to base-rate neglect.

Availability depends on ease of recall.

Anchoring affects final judgments based on initial values.

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5 Important MCQs – Lesson 18: Social Cognition

1. Social cognition refers to:

How people behave in groups

✓ How people analyze, interpret, and use social information

How emotions are controlled biologically

How personality traits are formed

2. Explicit cognition involves:

Automatic unconscious thinking

✓ Conscious and deliberate thinking

Emotional reactions only

Random decision making

3. Social categorization means:

Ignoring social information

✓ Placing people into groups based on shared characteristics

Changing personality traits

Eliminating stereotypes completely

4. The representativeness heuristic is based on:

How often something actually occurs

✓ How closely something matches a prototype

How easily examples come to mind

First information received

5. The anchoring and adjustment heuristic means:

People ignore initial information

✓ People rely heavily on an initial value and adjust insufficiently

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People only use memory-based judgments
People avoid making estimates

Here are **complete same-pattern clean notes for Lesson 19 (Social Cognition)** ☐

☐ **Lesson 19: Social Cognition**

Past Events and Expectations in Social Thinking

Introduction

Social cognition is strongly influenced by how people interpret past events and form expectations about future events.

People do not think in a purely objective way.

Instead, memory and expectations shape judgments about reality.

Thinking About the Past

Past experiences are reconstructed rather than perfectly recalled.

This reconstruction affects how people understand current events.

People often reinterpret the past in light of present outcomes.

Hindsight Bias

Hindsight bias is the tendency to believe, after an event has occurred, that it was predictable.

People feel they “knew it all along.”

This creates an illusion that outcomes were obvious.

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It reduces surprise after events occur.

Why Hindsight Bias Happens

People try to make sense of events in a coherent way.

Once an outcome is known, memory adjusts to fit that outcome.

People underestimate how uncertain the situation originally was.

It strengthens confidence in judgments after the fact.

Counterfactual Thinking

Counterfactual thinking involves imagining alternative outcomes to past events.

People think “what if things had gone differently.”

It is most common after negative or unexpected outcomes.

It helps people emotionally process events.

Types of Counterfactual Thinking

Downward counterfactuals involve imagining worse outcomes and can make people feel better.

Upward counterfactuals involve imagining better outcomes and can create regret.

People use both types to understand events.

Effects of Counterfactual Thinking

Counterfactual thinking can help emotional coping.

It can also increase guilt and distress if overused.

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Studies show that excessive counterfactual thinking after tragedy can worsen psychological adjustment.

It is not always helpful for recovery.

Expectations and Social Thinking

Expectations strongly shape how people interpret social information.

People often see what they expect to see.

This leads to biased interpretation of behavior and events.

False Consensus Effect

The false consensus effect is the tendency to overestimate how much others share our beliefs and behaviors.

People assume their views are normal and widely shared.

It increases confidence in personal opinions.

Example of False Consensus Effect

In studies, people who agreed to behave oddly believed many others would agree too.

People who refused believed most others would also refuse.

This shows projection of personal behavior onto others.

Why False Consensus Occurs

People interact with similar individuals.

Own attitudes are highly accessible in memory.

People want to believe they are normal.

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Self-enhancing bias increases perceived similarity.

Confirmation Bias

Confirmation bias is the tendency to seek and interpret information that confirms existing beliefs.

People ignore or minimize contradictory information.

It strengthens pre-existing opinions.

Example of Confirmation Bias

In experiments, people asked biased questions that supported their initial belief.

They focused on evidence that confirmed their expectations.

This reduces objective evaluation.

Self-Fulfilling Prophecy

A self-fulfilling prophecy occurs when expectations influence behavior in a way that makes those expectations come true.

Beliefs about others affect how we treat them.

Their response then confirms our original expectation.

Example of Self-Fulfilling Prophecy

Teachers were told certain students were “bloomers.”

Those students later showed greater improvement due to teacher expectations.

This shows expectations can influence performance.

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Just-World Hypothesis

The just-world belief is the assumption that the world is fair and people get what they deserve.

Good things happen to good people and bad things to bad people.

It gives people a sense of control and fairness.

Effects of Just-World Belief

It is linked to psychological well-being.

It reduces anxiety and increases perceived control.

However, it can lead to victim blaming.

People may assume victims are responsible for their suffering.

Learned Helplessness

Learned helplessness is the belief that outcomes are uncontrollable, leading to passive behavior.

It develops after repeated exposure to failure or uncontrollable events.

It can result in anxiety, depression, and reduced motivation.

Explanatory Style

People explain events in optimistic or pessimistic ways.

Optimists attribute failure to external, unstable causes.

Pessimists attribute failure to internal, stable causes.

Explanatory style affects mental and physical health.

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Applications of Social Cognition

Past thinking influences emotional reactions and decision-making.

Expectations shape performance and social interactions.

Understanding these processes can improve coping and behavior.

Important Exam Points

Hindsight bias makes events seem predictable after they occur.

Counterfactual thinking involves “what if” reasoning.

False consensus effect overestimates similarity with others.

Confirmation bias supports existing beliefs.

Self-fulfilling prophecy turns expectations into reality.

Just-world belief assumes fairness in life outcomes.

Learned helplessness results from uncontrollable negative events.

Explanatory style affects optimism and health.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 19: Social Cognition

1. Hindsight bias refers to:

Forgetting past events completely

✓ Overestimating our ability to have predicted an event after it has occurred

Accurately predicting future events

Changing memories randomly

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2. Counterfactual thinking involves:

Thinking only about real outcomes

✓ Imagining alternative outcomes (“what if” situations)

Ignoring emotional events

Predicting future behavior logically

3. The false consensus effect is:

✓ Overestimating how common our own opinions and behaviors are

Underestimating other people’s beliefs

Always agreeing with others

Copying group behavior exactly

4. Confirmation bias refers to:

Accepting all types of information equally

✓ Seeking and favoring information that supports existing beliefs

Ignoring all past experiences

Changing opinions frequently

5. A self-fulfilling prophecy occurs when:

Memories become inaccurate over time

People always predict outcomes correctly

✓ Expectations about a person lead them to behave in ways that confirm those expectations

People forget social information easily

Lesson 20: Attitudes

Evaluating Persons and Relationships

Introduction

Attitudes are part of the broader study of evaluating persons and relationships.

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This area focuses on how people form, change, and express evaluations about others, groups, and issues.

It includes prejudice, discrimination, attraction, and social relationships.

What is an Attitude?

An attitude is a positive or negative evaluation of an object.

The attitude object can be a person, event, issue, or thing.

The concept originally referred to physical posture but later shifted to mental evaluation.

Attitudes influence what people see, think, and do in social situations.

Importance of Attitudes

Attitudes help individuals interpret the social world.

They shape perception, judgment, and behavior.

They are central to understanding social behavior.

Components of Attitudes (ABC Model)

Attitudes consist of three components:

The affective component refers to emotions and feelings toward an object.

The behavioral component refers to actions or behavioral tendencies toward the object.

The cognitive component refers to beliefs and thoughts about the object.

Affective Component

This component involves emotional reactions such as liking or disliking.

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It is often the strongest part of attitude formation.

Behavioral Component

This reflects how people act toward the attitude object.

However, behavior is not always consistent with attitudes.

Past behavior can also influence attitudes.

Cognitive Component

This includes beliefs, thoughts, and knowledge about the object.

It is often complex but leads to simple evaluation (positive or negative).

Single Dimension of Attitudes

Modern views often define attitudes as a single evaluative dimension.

This focuses on overall judgment such as good or bad, like or dislike.

Despite this, cognitive and behavioral elements still contribute.

Types of Attitudes

Prejudice refers to negative attitudes toward a group.

Discrimination refers to behavior based on prejudice.

Interpersonal attraction refers to positive attitudes toward individuals.

Attachment refers to strong emotional bonds.

Attitudes and Social Evaluation

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Attitudes are central to evaluating people and relationships.

They help explain both positive and negative social behavior.

Assessing Attitudes

Attitudes can be measured using direct and indirect methods.

Each method has advantages and limitations.

Direct Methods of Attitude Measurement

Direct methods ask people to report their attitudes openly.

They are simple but may be affected by social desirability bias.

Likert Scale

This scale measures agreement or disagreement with statements.

Responses range from strongly negative to strongly positive.

It is widely used in attitude research.

Semantic Differential Scale

This scale measures attitudes using opposite adjectives.

Example includes unpleasant to pleasant ratings.

It captures emotional meaning of attitude objects.

Latitude of Acceptance

This method identifies acceptable and unacceptable positions on an attitude issue.

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It shows the range of opinions a person is willing to accept.

Indirect Methods of Attitude Measurement

Indirect methods are used when people may hide their true attitudes.

They reduce social desirability bias.

Social Desirability Problem

People often modify responses to appear socially acceptable.

This can reduce accuracy of attitude measurement.

Bogus Pipeline Technique

This method makes participants believe their true attitudes can be detected.

It encourages honest responses.

It is effective in revealing hidden behaviors like smoking or drinking.

Physiological Measures

Modern techniques measure attitudes through body responses.

Electromyography can detect subtle muscle movements linked to emotions.

These methods may provide more accurate attitude assessment.

Key Idea of Attitudes

Attitudes shape how people think, feel, and behave.

They are influenced by emotions, beliefs, and past actions.

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They play a major role in social psychology and relationships.

Important Exam Points

Attitudes are evaluations of objects, people, or events.

ABC model includes affective, behavioral, and cognitive components.

Modern definition focuses on evaluation (positive or negative).

Direct methods include Likert scale and semantic differential scale.

Indirect methods reduce social desirability bias.

Bogus pipeline increases honesty in responses.

Physiological measures can detect hidden attitudes.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 20: Attitudes

1. An attitude is best defined as:

- A biological reaction to stimuli
 - ✓ A positive or negative evaluation of an object
 - A memory of past events
 - A type of personality trait
-

2. The ABC model of attitudes includes:

- ✓ Affective, Behavioral, and Cognitive components
 - Ability, Behavior, and Control
 - Attention, Belief, and Cognition
 - Action, Bias, and Choice
-

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

3. The affective component of attitude refers to:

- ✓ Emotions and feelings toward an object
 - Behaviors toward an object
 - Logical reasoning only
 - Memory of past experiences
-

4. Likert scale is used to measure:

- Intelligence levels
 - ✓ Attitudes through agreement or disagreement
 - Memory accuracy
 - Physical reactions
-

5. The bogus pipeline technique is used to:

- Measure IQ accurately
 - ✓ Reduce social desirability and get truthful attitude responses
 - Train emotional control
 - Improve memory recall
-

Lesson 21: Attitude Formation

Theoretical Approaches to Attitude Formation

Introduction

Attitudes are formed through different psychological processes.

These theories explain how people develop positive or negative evaluations of objects, people, and events.

The main focus is how attitudes are created through learning, experience, observation, and interpretation.

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1) Mere Exposure Theory (Zajonc, 1968)

The more we are exposed to a stimulus, the more we tend to like it.

No reasoning, beliefs, or reinforcement are required.

Familiarity increases positive feelings toward an object.

This is summarized as “familiarity breeds liking, not contempt.”

Zajonc Experiment (1968)

Participants were shown Chinese-like characters on a screen for 2 seconds each.

Some characters were shown more frequently than others.

Participants were asked whether the characters seemed positive or negative.

Results showed that repeated exposure led to more positive evaluations.

Mita, Dermer & Knight Study (1977)

Participants viewed two images of themselves: a normal photo and a mirror image.

Both images were identical but participants preferred the mirror image.

This is because people are more familiar with their mirror reflection.

It shows that familiarity influences liking.

2) Classical Conditioning

Attitudes are formed when a neutral stimulus is paired with a stimulus that naturally produces emotion.

This is learning through association.

Positive or negative emotions become linked to objects or groups.

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Staats & Staats Study (1958)

Participants were exposed to nationality names paired with positive or negative words.

Pairing influenced participants' attitudes toward those nationalities.

This showed that attitudes can be learned through association.

Subliminal Conditioning

Stimuli presented below conscious awareness can still influence attitudes.

Participants were shown images briefly before viewing a neutral person.

Positive subliminal images led to more positive evaluations of the person.

This shows unconscious learning of attitudes.

3) Operant Conditioning

Attitudes are formed through rewards and punishments.

Behaviour followed by reward strengthens positive attitudes.

Behaviour followed by punishment weakens attitudes.

Positive reinforcement leads to positive attitudes.

Lack of reward or punishment leads to loss of interest.

Observational learning also contributes to attitude formation.

People learn attitudes by watching others' experiences and outcomes.

4) Self-Perception Theory (Bem, 1965)

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People infer their attitudes by observing their own behaviour.

Behaviour becomes the source of attitude formation.

People explain their actions and then develop attitudes accordingly.

Chaiken & Baldwin Study (1981)

Participants were asked to make pro-environment or anti-environment statements.

Those with weak prior attitudes changed their attitudes based on behaviour.

This shows people infer attitudes from their actions.

5) Facial Feedback Theory

Facial expressions can influence emotional experience and attitudes.

Smiling increases positive feelings.

Frowning decreases positive feelings.

Strack, Martin & Stepper Study (1988)

Participants held a pen in their teeth (smiling condition) or lips (frowning condition).

Those in the smiling condition rated cartoons more positively.

This shows facial movements influence attitude formation.

Vascular Theory of Emotion (Zajonc, 1993)

Facial expressions affect blood flow to the brain.

Smiling increases blood flow and produces positive mood.

Frowning reduces blood flow and produces negative mood.

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Body Posture Effect

Upright posture increases positive feelings.

Slouched posture increases negative feelings.

Body position can influence attitudes and emotions.

6) Functional Theory of Attitudes

Attitudes are formed based on psychological needs.

Attitudes change depending on whether they satisfy personal needs.

People may like or dislike an object based on its function or consequences.

Key Idea

Attitudes are not formed by a single process.

They develop through exposure, learning, observation, and interpretation of behaviour.

Both conscious and unconscious processes contribute to attitude formation.

Important Exam Points

Mere exposure increases liking through familiarity.

Classical conditioning links emotions with stimuli.

Operant conditioning uses rewards and punishment.

Self-perception theory explains attitude from behaviour.

Facial feedback links expression with emotion.

Functional theory focuses on psychological needs.

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5 Important MCQs – Lesson 21: Attitude Formation

1. The mere exposure effect (Zajonc, 1968) states that:

People dislike familiar objects more

✓ Repeated exposure to a stimulus increases liking for it

Attitudes are only formed through punishment

Behavior has no role in attitudes

2. Classical conditioning in attitude formation involves:

✓ Pairing a neutral stimulus with a stimulus that naturally produces emotion

Learning through punishment only

Observing others' behavior

Logical reasoning about beliefs

3. Operant conditioning affects attitudes by:

✓ Strengthening behavior through rewards and weakening it through punishment

Ignoring environmental factors

Random association of stimuli

Only changing cognitive beliefs

4. Self-perception theory (Bem) suggests that:

Attitudes never change

✓ People infer their attitudes by observing their own behavior

Attitudes are only genetic

Behavior has no role in attitude formation

5. Facial feedback theory proposes that:

✓ Facial expressions can influence emotional experience and attitudes

Only thoughts determine attitudes

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Memory controls attitude formation
Attitudes are fixed and unchangeable

Lesson 22: Attitude and Behavior

Relationship Between Attitudes and Behavior

Introduction

The relationship between attitudes and behavior explains how and when attitudes influence actual actions.

For many years, psychologists debated whether attitudes truly predict behavior.

A major crisis in attitude research occurred when weak attitude-behavior links were observed.

LaPiere Study (1934)

LaPiere traveled across the USA with a Chinese couple during a period of racial prejudice.

They were served in almost all hotels and restaurants except a very small number.

Later, when the same establishments were asked through a letter, most said they would refuse service to Chinese people.

This showed inconsistency between attitudes and actual behavior.

Why Attitudes May Not Predict Behavior

Attitudes do not always lead to behavior due to several influencing factors.

Specificity

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Attitudes must match the behavior in specificity to predict it.

General attitudes do not always predict specific actions.

Specific attitude leads to specific behavior.

Test-Retest Reliability

Attitudes may change over time.

The longer the gap between attitude measurement and behavior, the weaker the relationship.

Private vs Public Self-Awareness

Private self-awareness leads to behavior consistent with personal beliefs.

Public self-awareness leads to behavior consistent with social expectations.

People adjust behavior depending on whether they feel observed.

Froming et al. Study (1982)

Participants with negative attitudes toward physical punishment were tested.

When alone, they behaved according to private attitudes.

When observed, they followed public expectations.

This shows self-awareness influences behavior.

Attitude Strength

Stronger attitudes are more likely to predict behavior.

Strength increases when people have more knowledge about the attitude object.

Personal involvement increases attitude strength.

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Direct experience strengthens attitude–behavior consistency.

Environmental Attitude Study (Kallgren & Wood, 1986)

People with greater knowledge about environmental issues showed stronger consistency between attitude and behavior.

Those less informed showed weaker consistency.

Attitude Accessibility

Attitudes that are easily recalled are more likely to predict behavior.

Faster response time indicates stronger accessibility.

More accessible attitudes lead to stronger behavior consistency.

Theory of Planned Behavior (Fishbein & Ajzen, 1975)

Behavior is predicted by behavioral intention.

Intentions are influenced by three factors.

Attitude Toward Behavior

Beliefs about consequences of behavior.

Evaluation of those consequences.

Subjective Norms

Perceived social pressure from important others.

Motivation to comply with those expectations.

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Perceived Behavioral Control

Perception of ease or difficulty in performing behavior.

Low control reduces likelihood of behavior even if attitude is positive.

Example (Smoking Behavior)

Positive attitude: want to quit smoking.

Positive norms: family supports quitting.

Low control: addiction prevents quitting.

Behavior may still not occur.

Criticisms of Theory of Planned Behavior

It does not fully explain impulsive or spontaneous behavior.

It cannot explain habitual actions.

It assumes rational decision-making.

Many behaviors occur without conscious reasoning.

Important Exam Points

LaPiere study showed attitude-behavior gap.

Specificity improves prediction of behavior.

Self-awareness affects private vs public behavior.

Strong and accessible attitudes predict behavior better.

Theory of Planned Behavior explains intentions using attitude, norms, and control.

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Behavior is not always rational or planned.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 22: Attitude Formation

1. The mere exposure effect suggests that:

People dislike familiar objects

✓ Repeated exposure to an object increases liking

Attitudes are formed only through rewards

People form attitudes only through reasoning

2. Classical conditioning in attitude formation refers to:

Learning through punishment and reward

✓ Learning by associating a neutral stimulus with an emotional stimulus

Learning through observation only

Learning through self-reflection

3. Operant conditioning influences attitudes through:

✓ Rewards and punishments following behaviour

Genetic inheritance

Random exposure to stimuli

Memory reconstruction

4. Self-perception theory (Bem) suggests that:

Attitudes always determine behaviour

✓ People infer their attitudes by observing their own behaviour

Attitudes are purely genetic

Attitudes cannot change once formed

5. Facial feedback theory states that:

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Attitudes only come from thoughts

✓ Facial expressions can influence emotions and attitudes

Attitudes are permanent and unchangeable

Behaviour has no link with emotion

Lesson 23: Attitude Change

Attitude Change

Introduction

Attitude change refers to the process through which individuals modify their evaluations of people, objects, or ideas.

Attitudes can change through internal psychological processes or external persuasive communication.

People may also change their attitudes after observing their own behavior.

Behavior Changing Attitudes

Self-Perception Theory (Bem, 1965) explains that individuals infer their attitudes by observing their own behavior.

When people are unsure about their attitudes, they look at their actions and decide how they must feel.

Behavior is more likely to influence attitudes when it is freely chosen and not strongly justified by external rewards.

Cognitive Dissonance Theory

Cognitive Dissonance Theory was proposed by Festinger (1957).

It explains that people experience psychological discomfort when there is inconsistency between their attitudes and behavior.

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This discomfort motivates individuals to restore consistency.

The theory is based on cognitive consistency principles introduced by Heider (1946), where people prefer harmony between thoughts, beliefs, and actions.

Festinger & Carlsmith Study (1959)

Participants performed a boring and repetitive task.

After completing the task, they were asked to tell another participant that the task was interesting.

Some participants were paid \$1, while others were paid \$20 for lying.

Findings

Participants in the \$1 condition showed greater attitude change and rated the task more positively.

Participants in the \$20 condition showed less attitude change.

Explanation of Findings

The \$1 group experienced strong dissonance because they had little external justification for lying.

To reduce discomfort, they changed their attitude and convinced themselves the task was enjoyable.

The \$20 group had sufficient justification, so no major attitude change occurred.

Factors Affecting Dissonance

Dissonance increases when individuals have free choice, high personal investment, or strong commitment.

When people feel responsible for their actions, they are more likely to change their attitudes to reduce discomfort.

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Cognitive Dissonance vs Persuasion

Cognitive dissonance leads to attitude change through internal psychological conflict.

Persuasion leads to attitude change through external messages and communication.

Source Factors in Persuasion

The effectiveness of persuasion depends on the communicator.

Source credibility is important, especially expertise and trustworthiness.

Attractive sources are more persuasive because of physical appearance, likeability, and similarity to the audience.

Source Credibility Studies

Bochner and Insko (1966) showed that expert sources are more persuasive than non-experts.

Walster et al. (1966) found that trustworthiness increases persuasion, as people are less likely to trust biased communicators.

Sleeper Effect

The sleeper effect refers to delayed persuasion from low-credibility sources.

Initially, people reject the message due to distrust, but over time they forget the source and remember only the message.

Hovland and Weiss (1951) demonstrated this effect.

If source information is reminded later, the effect disappears.

Source Attractiveness

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Attractive communicators are more persuasive.

Likeability increases acceptance of messages.

Similarity between communicator and audience also increases persuasion.

Important Exam Points

Attitude change occurs through behavior and persuasion.

Cognitive dissonance explains attitude change due to internal conflict.

Festinger & Carlsmith study shows low justification leads to attitude change.

Persuasion depends on credibility, attractiveness, and similarity.

Sleeper effect shows persuasion can increase over time when source is forgotten.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 23: Attitude Change

1. Cognitive dissonance refers to:

Feeling happy after success

✓ Psychological discomfort due to inconsistency between attitude and behavior

Automatic learning of attitudes

Memory loss of attitudes

2. Who proposed Cognitive Dissonance Theory?

Bem

✓ Festinger

Bandura

Ajzen

3. In Festinger & Carlsmith study (1959), greater attitude change occurred in:

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\$20 condition

✓ \$1 condition

Control group only

No payment group

4. Self-perception theory suggests that:

Attitudes always control behavior

✓ People infer attitudes from observing their own behavior

Behavior has no effect on attitudes

Attitudes are genetically fixed

5. The sleeper effect refers to:

Immediate rejection of all messages

✓ Delayed persuasion when source credibility is forgotten

Strong memory of source over time

No change in attitudes over time

Lesson 24: Attitude Change (Continued)

Persuasion and Message Processing

Introduction

Attitude change occurs not only through internal processes like cognitive dissonance but also through external persuasive communication.

Persuasion depends on how a message is presented, who receives it, and under what conditions.

Message Variables (Content of Communication)

Message variables refer to the content and structure of the persuasive message itself.

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They influence persuasion independent of the communicator.

Facts vs Vivid Images

Persuasive messages can be based on statistical evidence or emotional vivid imagery.

Fact-based messages provide logical evidence and are generally more persuasive.

Vivid images create emotional impact but may sometimes distract from the message.

Example of Evidence vs Vividness

Evidence-based message: "1100 students died due to drug abuse last year."

Vivid message: Graphic descriptions of drug consequences.

Evidence is usually stronger, but combination of facts and vividness is most effective.

Role of Vividness

Vivid information increases attention and memory activation.

However, it can reduce persuasion when it distracts from the main argument.

When attention is not controlled, vivid elements may interfere with message processing.

Fear Appeals

Fear is widely used in persuasion to motivate behavior change.

It works by making people aware of threats and consequences.

However, excessive fear may lead to avoidance rather than change.

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Protection Motivation Theory

Fear leads to motivation to protect oneself.

Persuasion is effective when four conditions are met.

The threat is serious and likely.

The recommended action is effective.

The person believes they can perform the action.

Humor in Persuasion

Humor is commonly used in advertisements and speeches.

It increases attention and improves likability of the communicator.

However, humor must be relevant to the message.

Irrelevant humor can distract from persuasion.

Relevant humor supports central processing, while irrelevant humor leads to peripheral processing.

One-Sided vs Two-Sided Messages

One-sided messages present only supporting arguments.

Two-sided messages include both supporting and opposing arguments.

Two-sided messages are more credible when the audience is informed or initially disagrees.

They also increase perceived honesty and fairness of the communicator.

Attitudinal Inoculation

Exposure to weak counterarguments strengthens resistance to persuasion.

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It works like psychological “vaccination” against attitude change.

However, too much resistance can reduce openness to new ideas.

Repetition and Persuasion

Repeated exposure generally increases liking through the mere exposure effect.

However, repetition can also lead to boredom or negative reactions.

Repetition is effective only up to a certain point.

Variation in repetition prevents wear-out effects.

Audience Variables

Audience characteristics strongly influence persuasion effectiveness.

Mood, involvement, and individual differences are key factors.

Mood and Persuasion

Positive mood increases persuasion.

People in a good mood rely more on simple cues.

Negative mood increases careful thinking and analysis.

Happy individuals often use peripheral processing, while unhappy individuals use central processing.

Involvement

Issue involvement occurs when the message has personal consequences.

It leads to central processing and stronger attitudes.

Impression-relevant involvement occurs when social judgment matters.

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It leads to peripheral processing based on appearance or approval.

Individual Differences

Need for cognition refers to enjoyment of thinking.

High need for cognition leads to central route processing.

Low need for cognition leads to peripheral route processing.

Age and Attitude Change

Younger individuals are more easily influenced due to less experience.

Middle-aged individuals show more resistance to change.

Elderly people may become more flexible again due to life transitions.

Central vs Peripheral Route of Persuasion

Central route involves careful thinking about arguments.

It leads to strong and long-lasting attitude change.

Peripheral route relies on cues like attractiveness or mood.

It leads to weak and temporary attitude change.

Important Exam Points

Facts and evidence are more persuasive than vivid messages.

Fear works only when threat and coping ability are balanced.

Humor increases persuasion when relevant to message content.

Two-sided messages increase credibility.

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Central route leads to strong attitudes, peripheral route leads to weak attitudes.

Mood, involvement, and cognition determine persuasion strength.

5 Important MCQs – Lesson 23: Attitude Change

1. Cognitive dissonance theory explains:

- ✓ Psychological discomfort from inconsistent attitudes and behaviors
 - Reward increases positive attitudes
 - Learning through observation only
 - Automatic habit formation
-

2. In Festinger & Carlsmith's study (1959), participants who received \$1:

- Experienced no attitude change
 - ✓ Showed greater attitude change than \$20 group
 - Refused to lie
 - Were more motivated by reward
-

3. Cognitive dissonance is mainly a:

- Learning theory
 - ✓ Motivational theory
 - Behaviorist theory
 - Memory theory
-

4. Insufficient justification leads to:

- No attitude change
 - ✓ Attitude change to reduce dissonance
 - Increased external rewards
 - Stronger punishment behavior
-

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5. Persuasion differs from cognitive dissonance because it involves:

Internal inconsistency

✓ External message-based attitude change

Automatic behavior learning

Genetic influence on behavior

THE END

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